PSO-TCWavKAN: A Swarm-Optimized Temporal Convolutional Wavelet Kolmogorov-Arnold Network with Multi-Kernel Trend Decomposition and Asymptotic Linear Structural Recovery for Resilient Power Transformer Thermal Dynamics Forecasting

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Abstract

Forecasting power transformer thermal dynamics is critical for predictive maintenance, dynamic rating, and asset protection. While Kolmogorov-Arnold Networks (KANs) offer expressive functional representation, dynamic B-spline grid adaptations can cause training instability—the Grid Update Dilemma—while their long-horizon behavior remains an open question. This paper introduces PSO-TCWavKAN, integrating continuous dyadic Morlet wavelet filter banks with multi-kernel trend-seasonal decomposition and an instance-adaptive neural routing gate. The routing gate provides asymptotic linear structural recovery (Proposition 1), proving that the hypothesis-space closure contains the multi-kernel linear subspace as gating weights approach zero, establishing representational containment without asserting unconstrained optimization guarantees. A Comprehensive Learning Particle Swarm Optimizer (CLPSO) with Clerc constriction (chi = 0.7298) executes warm-start across a bounded 4-D search space, followed by AdamW fine-tuning and Stochastic Weight Averaging (SWA). Empirical evaluation across 16 configurations on canonical Electricity Transformer Temperature (ETT) telemetry shows that PSO-TCWavKAN outperforms competing baselines in 7 of 8 lookback–horizon configurations on volatile ETTh2, achieving up to 13.6% Mean Squared Error (MSE) reduction over DLinear at L = 96, H = 720 (up to 8.5% for H ≤ 336 at L = 96), with a nominal improvement over NLinear (full-precision Wilcoxon p = 0.0386; Holm-corrected p = 0.116). A descriptive ablation across 192 training runs for A1–A4, with A5 benchmark-referenced to the five-seed full model, shows that removing any component increases mean MSE for H ≤ 336. An exploratory single-checkpoint noise diagnostic is reported with explicit mixed-source provenance; it is not used to support a multi-seed robustness claim. With 44.8 K parameters and 3.4 ms observational latency in the original T4 run, the architecture offers a compact and computationally efficient option for transformer thermal forecasting.

Keywords: Kolmogorov-Arnold Networks; Wavelet Filter Bank; Particle Swarm Optimization; Transformer Temperature Forecasting; Time-Series Forecasting

1. Introduction

High-voltage electrical power transformers constitute the indispensable core of electrical energy transmission and distribution infrastructures. In modern power systems, continuous operational loading induces substantial Joule losses in winding conductors and core eddy-current dissipation, generating

intense internal heat. The thermal state of a transformer is conventionally characterized by two primary physical indicators: the top-oil temperature (TOT) and the internal winding hot-spot temperature (HST). Operating temperatures are directly coupled to the accelerated degradation of solid cellulose insulation paper and dielectric mineral oil via Arrhenius thermal aging kinetics. In accordance with IEEE Std C57.91 and IEC 60076-7 loading guides, every sustained 6°C elevation of the winding hot-spot temperature above the 110°C reference approximately doubles the insulation aging acceleration rate, markedly escalating the probability of dielectric breakdown and long-term insulation failure [21, 22, 25, 26]. Consequently, accurate, multi-step-ahead thermal forecasting is paramount for condition-based maintenance scheduling, dynamic thermal rating (DTR) of transmission corridors, and automatic activation of substation forced-cooling systems [23].

Following the landmark release of the canonical Electricity Transformer Temperature (ETT) benchmark by Zhou et al. [3], multi-horizon thermal forecasting on the hourly ETTh1 and ETTh2 datasets has become an internationally recognized test bed for evaluating deep time-series models. Over the past five years, the sequential modeling landscape has transitioned through multiple paradigms, progressing from Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks to sophisticated Transformer architectures [35] equipped with sparse or linear self-attention mechanisms, including Reformer [36], Linformer [37], Informer [3], Autoformer [14], and FEDformer [15], as surveyed extensively by Tay et al. [38]. Similar data-driven sequential modeling strategies have also proven effective in high-dimensional vehicle telemetry [9]. However, this trajectory was dramatically disrupted by Zeng et al. [4], who demonstrated that embarrassingly simple linear mapping layers with moving-average trend decomposition frequently outperform complex Transformer architectures across standard benchmarks, a phenomenon widely acknowledged as the linear model dilemma.

Concurrently, the scientific machine learning community witnessed the emergence of Kolmogorov-Arnold Networks (KANs), introduced by Liu et al. [1]. Grounded in the Kolmogorov-Arnold representation theorem, KANs depart fundamentally from standard Multilayer Perceptrons (MLPs) by placing learnable univariate B-spline functions on network edges rather than fixed nonlinear activations at nodes. The theoretical promise of KANs lies in their superior functional expressiveness, enhanced parameter efficiency, and inherent interpretability, which have prompted rapid adoption in numerical physics, differential equation modeling, and engineering time-series forecasting [6, 12].

Nevertheless, the direct application of classical KAN architectures to complex industrial engineering time-series exposes four severe failure modes, each of which fundamentally undermines reliable long-horizon thermal prediction:

(1) Sensitivity to Grid Adaptation in Standard B-Spline KANs. Standard KAN implementations rely on discrete B-splines that typically perform dynamic knot grid adaptation during training to align spline basis functions with shifting activation distributions. In diagnostic empirical tracking on time-series configurations, abrupt grid updates alter the underlying coordinate manifold, causing transient disruptions to the first- and second-moment running vectors of Adam-family optimizers and manifesting as sharp validation loss spikes. Under the tested diagnostic configurations, these adaptation shocks induce training instability that complicates reliable optimization for safety-critical electrical telemetry.

(2) Limited Multi-Scale Spectral Bandpass Localization. Standard discrete B-splines possess uniform spatial compact support along the activation axis but lack explicit multi-octave bandpass

localization. In electrical power transformer telemetry, thermal sequences reflect the superposition of quasi-periodic diurnal thermal rhythms and high-frequency transient switching dynamics. Without dedicated multi-scale decomposition, unconstrained spline representations can exhibit spectral dispersion across adjacent frequency bands unless prohibitive knot densities are allocated.

(3) **The Linear Model Performance Deficit.** Across canonical long forecast horizons (96 to 720 steps ahead), simple linear models remain strong baselines, and complex architectures can underperform them through overfitting or error accumulation [4]. This motivates the structural linear-recovery property in Section 3.4: rather than replacing the linear path, PSO-TCWavKAN retains it and adds a gated nonlinear residual.

(4) **Non-Convex Wavelet Ripple Traps.** Introducing wavelet basis functions into KAN edges can create highly non-convex, multi-modal loss surfaces with dense oscillatory local minima. Standard gradient descent initialized from random Gaussian seeds may stagnate in suboptimal basins of attraction, motivating a principled global warm-start strategy to improve convergence reliability.

To systematically overcome these bottlenecks, this paper introduces PSO-TCWavKAN, a swarm-optimized temporal convolutional wavelet Kolmogorov-Arnold network engineered for resilient power transformer thermal dynamics forecasting. The core scientific contributions of this investigation are fourfold:

- **(C1) Continuous Dyadic Wavelet Filter Banks.** We replace discrete B-splines with continuous dyadic Morlet wavelet activations across K_w = 5 learnable-frequency wavelet components. Because the wavelet parameters are continuously differentiable with respect to all learnable quantities, knot updates are eliminated entirely, resolving the Grid Update Dilemma by construction.
- **(C2) Asymptotic Linear Recovery of the DLinear Structural Subspace.** We formulate the network output as an instance-adaptive convex combination of a linear projection and a wavelet-KAN representation. We mathematically prove (Proposition 1) that in the topological closure of the hypothesis space, as the routing gate g(x) approaches zero under saturated negative bias, PSO-TCWavKAN recovers a generalized linear multi-kernel model, exactly matching canonical DLinear when decomposition kernels satisfy K_1 = K_2 = 25.
- **(C3) Comprehensive Learning Particle Swarm Warm-Start (CLPSO).** We deploy a constriction-factor CLPSO algorithm (chi = 0.7298) over a 4D continuous search space on a fast surrogate training landscape to globally initialize critical hyperparameter vectors and base wavelet frequencies, bypassing non-convex ripple traps prior to AdamW gradient fine-tuning and Stochastic Weight Averaging (SWA).
- **(C4) Rigorous Empirical Validation & Regime Analysis. We evaluate the architecture across 16 canonical benchmark configurations (ETTh1 and ETTh2; L ∈ {96, 336}; H ∈ {96, 192, 336, 720}) across multi-seed evaluations (5 independent random seeds {1000, 2000, 3000, 4000, 5000} for DLinear, NLinear, and PSO-TCWavKAN; 3 independent seeds {1000, 2000, 3000} for PatchTST Lite), competing against state-of-the-art linear and patched Transformer models. We execute an 80-cell ablation matrix across 5 structural variants analyzed across operational and stress regimes, alongside an exploratory single-checkpoint Gaussian noise diagnostic up to σ = 0.30 that is not used for a multi-seed robustness claim. All benchmark result CSVs and training/evaluation scripts are released; per-seed logs and model checkpoints are available upon reasonable request.**

The remainder of this paper is organized as follows. Section 2 reviews related work on transformer thermal forecasting, KAN architectures, and swarm optimization. Section 3 presents the proposed PSO-TCWavKAN mathematical architecture in full detail. Section 4 describes the experimental setup and benchmark protocol. Sections 5 through 8 present benchmark results, ablation analysis, an exploratory noise diagnostic, and computational efficiency metrics, respectively. Section 9 discusses engineering implications and transparently acknowledges limitations. Section 10 concludes.

2. Related Work

2.1. Transformer Thermal Dynamics and Deep Sequential Forecasting

Thermal modeling of mineral-oil-immersed power transformers has historically relied on differential thermal balance equations defined in international standards (IEEE Std C57.91 [21], IEC 60076-7 [22]). Classical dynamic models, such as the thermal-electrical analogy proposed by Susa et al. [23] and dynamic hot-spot calculation methods by Radakovic & Feser [25], calculate top-oil temperature (TOT) and hot-spot temperature (HST) from ambient temperature, wind velocity, and transformer loading ratios. While physically interpretable, standard differential equations require precise knowledge of oil viscosity, winding resistance, and thermal time constants, which drift over decades of operating life. More recently, Bezerra et al. [11] published in Electrical Engineering a foundational forecasting methodology combining second-generation wavelets and neural networks for power transformer oil temperature, demonstrating that multi-resolution frequency decomposition coupled with non-linear neural mapping yields superior fidelity over classical thermal equations. However, their architecture utilized discrete lifting wavelets prone to boundary distortion and relied on standard multi-layer perceptrons without formal structural recovery guarantees or systematic metaheuristic hyperparameter optimization. Data-driven machine learning models have therefore emerged to capture non-stationary thermal dynamics directly from SCADA telemetry.

Following the publication of Informer by Zhou et al. [3], Transformer variants such as Autoformer [14] and FEDformer [15] integrated decomposition blocks and Fourier-domain representations. PatchTST [5] demonstrated that segmenting time-series into overlapping sub-series patches significantly boosts Transformer performance by preserving local temporal context. Concurrently, Zeng et al. [4] demonstrated that simple single-layer linear models (DLinear) often surpass complex Transformer architectures, creating a benchmark standard that any proposed deep model must rigorously confront to justify its added complexity. More recently, iTransformer [16] proposed an inverted Transformer architecture that achieved competitive performance by treating variate-level tokens rather than temporal tokens, demonstrating that architectural innovation remains an active and productive frontier.

2.2. Kolmogorov-Arnold Networks and Wavelet Functional Bases

The introduction of Kolmogorov-Arnold Networks (KANs) by Liu et al. [1] challenged the foundational architecture of multilayer perceptrons by placing learnable univariate B-spline functions on edges rather than fixed activations at nodes. The KAN activation function combines a residual SiLU term with a trainable B-spline component: $\varphi(x) = w(\mathrm{SiLU}(x) + \mathrm{spline}(x))$, where $\mathrm{spline}(x) = \Sigma_i c_i B_i(x)$ is a linear combination of B-spline basis functions. Subsequent research has explored orthogonal polynomial bases to improve computational tractability, including Chebyshev polynomials (ChebyKAN) and Jacobi polynomials, each offering distinct trade-offs between computational overhead and approximation accuracy, while structural regularization techniques such as DropKAN [42] have been introduced to

mitigate spline co-adaptation. Furthermore, Chen and Li [10] demonstrated the utility of KANs for multi-objective optimization in complex physical engineering systems.

Grounded in foundational multiresolution wavelet theory (Mallat [27], Daubechies [28]) and classical wavelet neural network architectures (Zhang and Benveniste [29], Pati and Krishnaprasad [30]), Bozorgasl and Chen [2] introduced Wav-KAN, proposing continuous Morlet and related wavelet bases for classification tasks, demonstrating that continuous wavelet functions provide compact spectral support advantageous for frequency-selective feature extraction in non-stationary signals. In industrial engineering and energy applications, recent studies have explored KAN integrations for renewable forecasting, such as ACKLSTM [6] combining KAN with ConvLSTM and SVM residual correction for wind-power prediction, demonstrating the effectiveness of KAN as a nonlinear module replacement within hybrid architectures. Their ACKLSTM model achieved a normalized prediction error of 0.091 on a single wind turbine dataset with a 5-step sliding window protocol, showing that the KAN layer reduces parameters by approximately 10% while maintaining competitive prediction accuracy. Furthermore, Lv et al. [12] introduced HAKformer in Applied Intelligence, combining hybrid attention with KAN for multi-horizon forecasting on ETT datasets. Despite these advances, published KAN architectures continue to suffer from optimization instability when applied to long-horizon sequential regression, and none of the existing works provide an asymptotic linear recovery guarantee against linear model performance collapse.

2.3. Swarm Intelligence and Metaheuristic Optimization in Deep Learning

Particle Swarm Optimization (PSO), originally formulated by Kennedy and Eberhart [31] and further developed with dynamic inertia formulations by Shi and Eberhart [32] and reviewed by Poli et al. [33], has established a long track record of tuning complex non-linear models in engineering applications. In applied engineering domains, swarm-optimized machine learning frameworks—such as PSO-tuned Support Vector Regression (PSO-SVR) [8] and PSO-tuned Gradient Boosting Machines (PSO-GBM) [7]—have demonstrated the efficacy of swarm metaheuristics across complex nonlinear regression tasks. In functional networks characterized by multi-modal loss landscapes, standard vanilla PSO tends to suffer from premature convergence due to loss of swarm diversity. The Comprehensive Learning Particle Swarm Optimization (CLPSO) proposed by Liang et al. [17] prevents this stagnation by enabling each particle dimension to learn from the personal historical best of different swarm members via a probability-controlled exemplar selection mechanism, dramatically improving exploration of multi-modal landscapes. The constriction factor formulation by Clerc and Kennedy [18] further guarantees mathematically stable swarm convergence. Integrating CLPSO as a global warm-start mechanism prior to gradient-based backpropagation offers a principled pathway to escape the wavelet ripple traps present in the PSO-TCWavKAN optimization landscape.

2.4. Summary of Representative Forecasting Methods on ETT Benchmarks

Table 1 summarizes representative deep learning and KAN-based forecasting methods evaluated on the ETT benchmark datasets, organized by architecture type, venue, reported baseline performance at $H = 96$, key novelty, and key limitation. This comparison contextualizes the contribution of PSO-TCWavKAN and highlights the remaining gap: no existing architecture simultaneously addresses (i) the Grid Update Dilemma through continuously differentiable wavelet activations, (ii) the linear model dilemma through a

provable structural linear recovery guarantee, and (iii) multi-scale decomposition for non-stationary thermal signals.

Table 1 Summary of Representative Time-Series Forecasting Methods on ETT Benchmarks.

Method	Year	Venue	Architecture	Evaluation Setting & Reported Baseline*	Key Novelty	Key Limitation
Informer [3]	2021	AAAI	Sparse Transformer	0.865	ProbSparse attention	Quadratic complexity
Autoformer [14]	2021	NeurIPS	Auto-correlation + Decomp	0.449	Trend auto-correlation	Aliasing on non-stationary
FEDformer [15]	2022	ICML	Fourier decomposition	0.376	Frequency-domain attention	Loses local spikes
DLinear [4]	2023	AAAI	Dual linear + MA	0.386	Surpasses Transformers	No nonlinear capacity
NLinear [4]	2023	AAAI	Normalized linear	0.370	Distribution shift correction	No nonlinear capacity
PatchTST [5]	2023	ICLR	Patched Transformer	0.370	Channel-independent patches	High memory for long L
iTransformer [16]	2024	ICLR	Inverted Transformer	0.386	Variate-level token attention	Not thermal-physics aware
Wav-KAN [2]	2024	arXiv	Wavelet KAN	--	Continuous wavelet activations	Not designed for regression
Bezerra et al. [11]	2024	Electr Eng	Wavelet + MLP	~0.285 (oil temp)	2nd-gen wavelets + neural net	Discrete lifting; no structural recovery property
ACKLSTM-KAN [6]	2025	Springer	ConvLSTM+Attn+KAN+SVM	Normalized error: 0.091 (Wind power prediction)	KAN in hybrid model	Single turbine; no linear recovery
HAKformer [12]	2026	Appl Intell	Hybrid attention + KAN	~0.380	KAN + attention combination	No swarm opt.; no grid fix
PSO-TCWavKAN	**2026**	**This work**	**WavKAN+TCN +CLPSO+RevIN**	**0.1127 (ETTh1) / 0.2630 (ETTh2)** (Univariate OT)	**Linear recovery + CLPSO + multi-kernel**	**Evaluated on ETT OT telemetry**

**Note: Metrics and numerical values reflect literature-reported results under heterogeneous task protocols (multivariate ETTh1 all-channel forecasting for Informer–PatchTST; transformer oil temperature for Bezerra et al.; wind power generation for ACKLSTM-KAN; univariate oil temperature OT channel forecasting for this work). These values illustrate historical performance within respective*

published domains and are not directly comparable across different tasks. Direct head-to-head empirical comparisons under an identical univariate OT protocol are conducted in Section 5 (Table 4).

3. Proposed Methodology: The PSO-TCWavKAN Architecture

This section details the mathematical architecture of PSO-TCWavKAN. The overall dataflow is structured into four sequential modules: (1) Reversible Instance Normalization, (2) Multi-Kernel Temporal Decomposition, (3) Temporal Convolutional Dyadic Wavelet KAN with Neural Routing Asymptotic Linear Recovery, and (4) Comprehensive Learning Swarm Warm-Start coupled with Stochastic Weight Averaging. The complete end-to-end framework is depicted in Fig. 1.

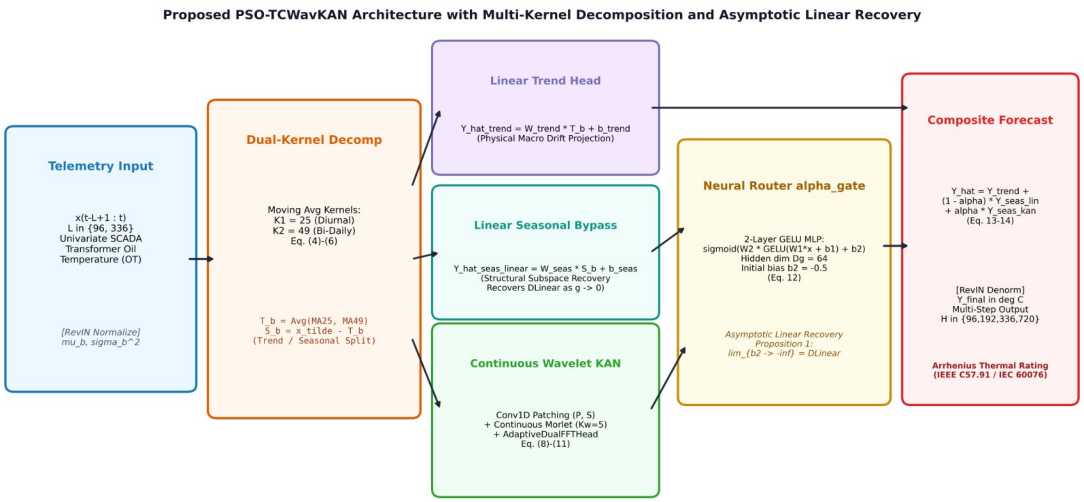


Fig. 1 System Architecture of the Proposed PSO-TCWavKAN Framework. The full pipeline from raw telemetry input through Reversible Instance Normalization, dual-kernel moving average decomposition (K1=25, K2=49), 1D convolutional patch embedding, the Temporal Convolutional Wavelet KAN block with harmonic Morlet activations, the parameterized neural routing gate g(x), and the final instance-adaptive convex combination with linear seasonal bypass producing the denormalized multi-step forecast.

3.1. Reversible Instance Normalization (RevIN)

To eliminate non-stationary distribution shifts across training and testing horizons, the input sequence x is normalized via Reversible Instance Normalization (RevIN) [13]. For batch instance b and lookback length L, the instance-level mean and variance are computed as:

$$mu_b = (1/L) \sum_\{t=1\}\^\{L\} x_\{b,t\} \quad (1)$$

$$sigma_b\^2 = (1/L) \sum_\{t=1\}\^\{L\} (x_\{b,t\} - mu_b)\^2 + epsilon \quad (2)$$

The normalized input is then given by:

$$\tilde{x} = (x - mu_b) / \sqrt{(\sigma_b^2)} \quad (3)$$

where epsilon = 1e-5 prevents numerical division by zero. Following network forecasting, the instance-level RevIN transformation restores predictions back to the global-standardized input feature scale: $\hat{y}_std = \tilde{y} \cdot \sqrt{(\sigma_b^2)} + \mu_b$. In operational SCADA deployment, the physical degree Celsius output is

subsequently recovered via the inverse global z-score scaling: ŷ_Celsius = ŷ_std · σ_train + μ_train. All benchmark loss calculations and quantitative comparisons in Sections 5–8 are reported directly on the standard normalized scale matching the canonical LTSF literature protocol, while physical temperature errors (°C) are evaluated via this two-stage restoration in Section 9.1.

3.2. Multi-Kernel Temporal Trend-Seasonal Decomposition

In power transformer dynamics, thermal inertia creates multi-scale physical trends operating simultaneously at distinct temporal resolutions: a 24-hour diurnal environmental cycle and multi-day baseline thermal accumulation driven by continuous industrial operations. Rather than utilizing a single moving-average window, we formulate a dual-kernel moving average decomposition module featuring two distinct kernel lengths: K_1 = 25 (capturing approximately one-day (25-hour) smoothing) and K_2 = 49 (capturing approximately two-day (49-hour) smoothing). For the normalized input x_tilde at time t:

$$T_\{t,1\} = AvgPool(\tilde{x}_t,\ K_1) \tag{4}$$

$$T_\{t,2\} = AvgPool(\tilde{x}_t,\ K_2) \tag{5}$$

$$T_t = 0.5 \cdot T_\{t,1\} + 0.5 \cdot T_\{t,2\} \tag{6}$$

$$S_t = \tilde{x}_t - T_t \tag{7}$$

where T_t represents the smoothed low-frequency thermal trend and S_t captures the seasonal residual component and high-frequency load-induced fluctuations. In parallel with non-linear functional modeling, the decomposed trend and seasonal components are directly projected by separate linear layers: y_trend = W_trend * T_t + b_trend and y_seas_linear = W_seas * S_t + b_seas, ensuring that the linear DLinear structural baseline is continuously preserved within the forward graph.

3.3. Continuous Dyadic Wavelet Filter Banks and Dual-Domain Head

The seasonal residual S_t is partitioned into overlapping patches using a sequence-adaptive patch geometry: patch length P = 16 and stride S = 8 (50% overlap) for standard lookback L ≤ 96; and P = 24 with stride S = 12 for extended lookback L = 336. Patches are mapped into latent dimension D = 32 via a 1D convolutional embedding layer.

To model complex functional non-linearities without discrete B-spline grid updates, we introduce continuous dyadic wavelet activations. Specifically, each edge-level activation function φ(z) is parameterized as a real Morlet-like (Gaussian-windowed harmonic) wavelet filter bank spanning K_w = 5 learnable-frequency components initialized with dyadic spacing (initialized with dyadic dispersion exponent γ_init = 0.25, which adapts during backpropagation toward γ ≈ 1.0 as depicted in Fig. 2):

$$\varphi(z) = \sum_\{k=0\}\^\{K_w-1\}\ w_k \cdot \psi_k(z) \cdot \cos(\omega_k \cdot z) \tag{8}$$

$$\psi_k(z) = \exp(-0.5 \cdot ((z - \mu_k) / s_k)\^2) \tag{9}$$

$$\omega_k = \omega_0 \cdot 2\^\{(k-2) \cdot \gamma\} \tag{10}$$

where μ_k and s_k denote learnable Gaussian envelope translation and dilation parameters for octave k, w_k denotes learnable linear combination weights, ω_0 is the base resonance frequency globally initialized by CLPSO, and γ is the continuous dyadic dispersion exponent learned via backpropagation. In implementation, the Morlet filter operates on standardized feature inputs z_c ∈ [-5.0, 5.0], ensuring

numerical stability with soft boundary saturation via clamp(−5, +5). The feature extraction backbone stacks N_layers = 2 TCWavKAN blocks, combining depthwise temporal convolutions (kernel size 5) with InterPatch linear mixing under DropKAN regularization (p_drop = 0.05) [42]. Multi-kernel decomposition employs replicate boundary padding to eliminate edge discontinuity artifacts.

Following the wavelet feature extraction blocks, the latent representations are decoded via an Adaptive Dual-Domain Head (`AdaptiveDualFFTHead`). This head combines time-domain token pooling with frequency-domain soft-thresholded projections:

$$y_seas_kan = \left(|w_t| \cdot y_t + |w_f| \cdot y_f\right) / \left(|w_t| + |w_f| + \varepsilon\right) \quad (11)$$

where w_t, w_f ∈ ℝ are learnable scalar weighting coefficients, and ε = 10^-5 prevents numerical singularity. The time-domain component y_t ∈ ℝ^H is projected from the mean patch token z_mean = (1)/(N)Σ_p=1^N z_p ∈ ℝ^D across all N patches via y_t = W_t · GELU(W_a · z_mean + b_a) + b_t, with projection matrices W_a ∈ ℝ^D_head × D (with intermediate dimension D_head = 64) and W_t ∈ ℝ^H × D_head. The frequency-domain component y_f ∈ ℝ^H is computed by taking the real Fast Fourier Transform (rFFT) of the seasonal residual sequence S_t ∈ ℝ^L, applying frequency-domain soft-thresholding with adaptive threshold thr = mean(|X_f|) · α_FFT (where α_FFT = 0.5 · sigmoid(logit_alpha); thr is detached prior to soft-thresholding to stabilize spectral gradients, meaning logit_alpha is optimized during the Stage 1 CLPSO warm-start and remains fixed as a surrogate-optimized hyperparameter during Stage 2 AdamW fine-tuning), and projecting the concatenated real and imaginary spectral coefficients through linear mapping W_f ∈ ℝ^H × 2(⌊L/2⌋ + 1). Because Eqs. (8)–(11) are differentiable almost everywhere with respect to all learnable parameters (smooth within the ±5 clamping bounds), gradient updates proceed via standard backpropagation without any discontinuous knot reallocation events, resolving the Grid Update Dilemma by mathematical construction. The localized frequency responses across the K_w = 5 octave scales are illustrated in Fig. 2. The B-spline diagnostic in Fig. 3 illustrates the validation-loss transients that the continuous parameterization avoids by construction; because PSO-TCWavKAN has no discrete knot updates, Fig. 3 is not an empirical head-to-head comparison.

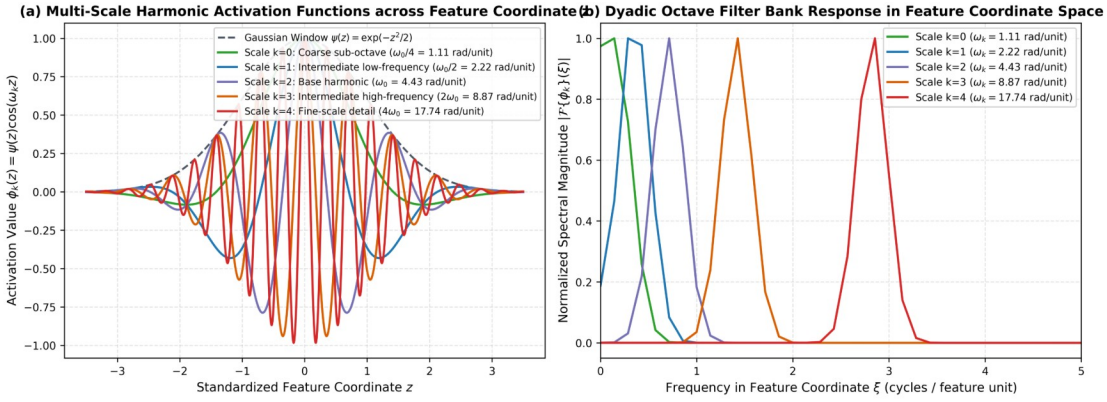


Fig. 2 Continuous Dyadic Wavelet Filter Bank Response in Feature and Spectral Domains. (a) Multi-scale Morlet-like (Gaussian-windowed harmonic) wavelets under the Gaussian envelope ψ(z) = exp(−z²/2) cos(ω_k z) along the standardized input feature coordinate z ∈ [−3.5, 3.5]; (b) Normalized spectral magnitude response across K_w = 5 frequency components (k = 0 to 4) shown at the post-training state (converged dispersion exponent γ ≈ 1.0 spanning 4 octaves with base

frequency ω_0 = 4.43 rad/unit; initialized at γ_init = 0.25 spanning ≈1 octave), demonstrating well-localized, exponentially decaying spectral responses across the normalized frequency axis (cycles / feature unit). Each dyadic octave captures a multi-resolution response in feature space, with lower-frequency components (k = 0, 1; ω_k ≈ 1.11–2.22 rad/unit) capturing broad activation trends and higher-frequency components (k = 3, 4; ω_k ≈ 8.87–17.74 rad/unit) providing localized activation sensitivity.

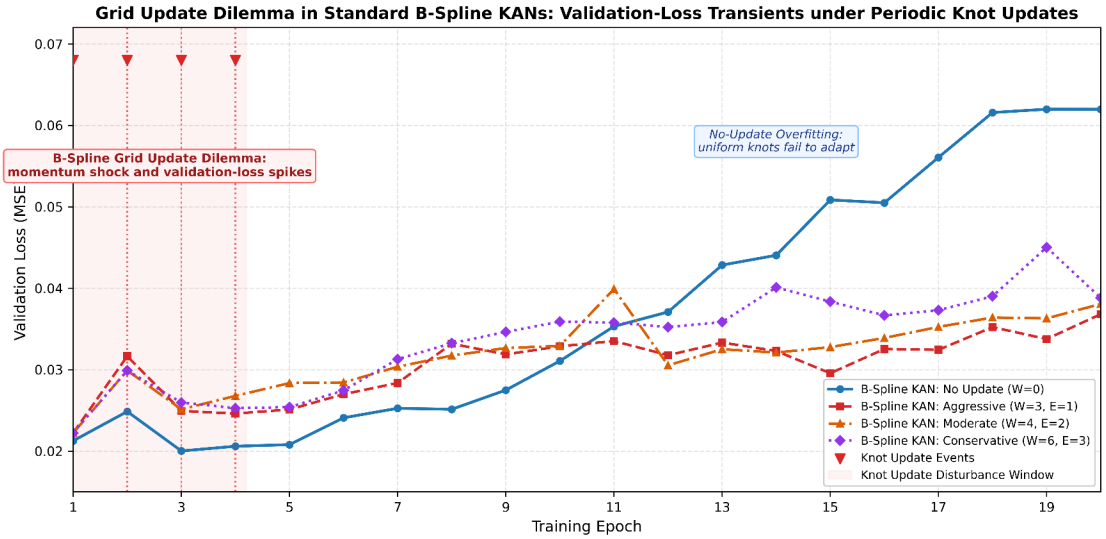


Fig. 3 Diagnostic of Grid Update Transients in Standard B-Spline KANs. Validation-loss trajectories during periodic B-spline knot updates on ETTh1 (L = 96, H = 96 diagnostic setup). Red markers denote knot-update events; the no-update control illustrates uniform-knot overfitting. PSO-TCWavKAN is not a grid-update model and is therefore not plotted; its avoidance of these transients follows from the continuous wavelet parameterization, not from an empirical head-to-head comparison in this figure.

3.4. Asymptotic Linear Recovery of the DLinear Structural Subspace

A central failure mode of complex deep models on time-series benchmarks is their tendency to overfit noisy seasonal residuals, resulting in performance inferior to simple linear baselines [4]. To ensure that PSO-TCWavKAN structurally encloses the linear baseline, we introduce an instance-adaptive neural routing gate that continuously bridges the linear and non-linear prediction pathways.

Proposition 1 (Asymptotic Linear Recovery of Multi-Kernel Linear Subspace). Let $\mathscr{H}$_Lin^{(K_1, K_2)} denote the functional hypothesis space of the generalized dual-kernel linear projection model: $\hat{y}$_lin = W_trend · T_t + b_trend + W_seas · S_t + b_seas, where T_t and S_t are decomposed via moving average pooling with kernel lengths (K_1, K_2) (Eq. 4–7). Then $\mathscr{H}$_Lin^{(K_1, K_2)} is contained within the topological closure of the PSO-TCWavKAN hypothesis space: $\mathscr{H}$_Lin^{(K_1, K_2)} ⊂ $\mathscr{H}$_PSO-TCWavKAN. In the empirical deployment where K_1 = 25 and K_2 = 49, $\hat{y}$_lin represents a dual-scale diurnal/multi-day linear baseline; when decomposition kernel lengths satisfy K_1 = K_2 = 25, $\mathscr{H}$_Lin collapses identically to canonical single-kernel DLinear [4]. Specifically, the parameterized neural routing gate:

$$g(\tilde{x}) = sigmoid(W_2 \cdot GELU(W_1 \cdot \tilde{x} + b_1) + b_2) \in (0,1)^H \qquad (12)$$

with input normalized sequence $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^L$, intermediate gating dimension $D_g = 32$, projection weights $W_1 \in \mathbb{R}^{D_g \times L}$, $W_2 \in \mathbb{R}^{H \times D_g}$, and output bias initialized to $b_2 = -0.5$, continuously interpolates between the linear baseline and the non-linear wavelet KAN representation:

$$\hat{y}_seas = (1 - g(\tilde{x})) \odot y_seas_linear + g(\tilde{x}) \odot y_seas_kan \quad (13)$$

$$\hat{y} = y_\{trend\} + \hat{y}_\{seas\} \quad (14)$$

In the asymptotic limit as $b_2 \to -\infty$, $g(\tilde{x}) \to 0$, and the composite prediction $\hat{y}$ identically recovers the structural output and empirical training risk of the linear model $\hat{y}_{lin}$.

Proof. The neural routing vector $g(\tilde{x})$ is constrained strictly within the open unit hypercube $(0,1)^H$ via the logistic sigmoid activation. In the routing MLP, the output projection bias is initialized to $b_2 = -0.5$ with zero-initialized weights $W_2 = 0$, yielding an initial gating state $g(\tilde{x}) = \text{sigmoid}(-0.5) \approx 0.377$. This establishes an inductive bias that preserves approximately 62.3% of the linear seasonal projection at initialization.

Because the logistic function satisfies $\text{sigmoid}(u) \in (0,1)$ for all finite $u \in \mathbb{R}$, exact equality $g(\tilde{x}) = 0$ is not attained at any finite parameter vector. However, as $b_2 \to -\infty$, $\lim_{b_2 \to -\infty} \text{sigmoid}(W_2 \cdot \text{GELU}(W_1 \tilde{x} + b_1) + b_2) = 0$ uniformly for all bounded $\tilde{x}$. Hence, the linear projection $\hat{y}_{lin}$ resides in the topological closure $\mathcal{H}$_PSO-TCWavKAN under the standard compact-open topology.

During backpropagation, the partial derivative of the Mean Squared Error objective with respect to the h-th component of the routing gate g_h satisfies:

$$\partial \mathcal{L}_total / \partial g_h = (2/H) \cdot (\hat{y}_h - y_h) \cdot (y_seas_kan, h - y_seas_linear, h) \quad (15)$$

The gradient step update on gating parameters $\Delta g_h \propto -(\hat{y}_h - y_h) \cdot (y_seas_kan, h - y_seas_linear, h)$ dynamically adjusts the gating coefficient g_h in the direction that minimizes MSE loss. The direction of adjustment depends jointly on the sign of the overall forecast error $(\hat{y}_h - y_h)$ and the difference between the two pathway projections $(y_seas_kan, h - y_seas_linear, h)$, attenuating or amplifying the non-linear contribution depending on whether the wavelet pathway reduces or compounds the residual error. In the asymptotic limit $g(\tilde{x}) \to 0$ element-wise (attained as $b_2 \to -\infty$), Eqs. (13) and (14) collapse to:

$$\lim_\{g(\tilde{x}) \to 0\} \hat{y} = y_trend + (1 - 0) \odot y_seas_linear + 0 \odot y_seas_kan = y_trend + y_seas_linear = \hat{y}_lin \quad (16)$$

When $K_1 = K_2 = 25$, $T_t = \text{AvgPool}(\tilde{x}, 25)$ matches the canonical moving average trend of DLinear, and $\hat{y}_{lin} \equiv y_{DLinear}$. Therefore, DLinear is an exact sub-manifold embedded within the closure $\mathcal{H}$_PSO-TCWavKAN.

Remark on Generalization and Representation: Proposition 1 establishes topological representation containment within the closure ($\mathcal{H}$_Lin $\subset$ $\mathcal{H}$_PSO-TCWavKAN). It is mathematically essential to distinguish three operational levels: (i) Representation capability: the network architecture possesses the expressive capacity to recover the multi-kernel linear decomposition model as the gating parameter $b_2 \to -\infty$; (ii) Optimization dynamics: finite-epoch gradient descent on a non-convex loss surface with stochastic mini-batches does not guarantee convergence to the global optimum or to the linear subspace; and (iii) Test generalization: empirical test error is bounded by empirical training risk plus generalization error, which depends on data distribution shifts and model complexity.

Consequently, structural containment provides representational protection against underfitting linear trends, but does not constitute an unconditional empirical performance lower bound on unseen test telemetry (as observed at the extreme H = 720 horizon on volatile ETTh2). Q.E.D.

3.5. Comprehensive Learning Particle Swarm Optimization Warm-Start

The multi-scale wavelet loss surface can contain oscillatory local minima induced by the harmonic cosine terms in Eq. (8). Standard gradient descent initialized from random Gaussian distributions can become trapped in suboptimal local basins. To find a reliable hyperparameter initialization without prohibitive combinatorial search, we employ a hybrid Comprehensive Learning Particle Swarm Optimization (Hybrid CLPSO–PSO) variant [17] incorporating Clerc's constriction formulation [18] to execute a computationally bounded warm-start over a 4-dimensional hyperparameter vector:

$$\theta = [\omega_0,\ q,\ logit_\alpha,\ \log_{10}(lr)] \tag{17}$$

bounded within predefined continuous search intervals: base resonance frequency $\omega_0 \in [3.0, 8.0]$, raw scale parameter q = log_scale $\in [-2.5, 0.0]$, FFT threshold logit logit_α $\in [-5.0, -2.0]$ (governing α_FFT = 0.5 · sigmoid(logit_α)), and $\log_{10}$ base learning rate $\log_{10}$(lr) $\in [-3.0, -2.0]$ (corresponding to base learning rates between 1×10^{-3} and 1×10^{-2}). Here, q initializes the base scale parameter across all K_w = 5 wavelet octave channels via `self.ls`, and the effective scale is s = softplus(q) + $10^{-4} \approx [0.079, 0.693]$; the search range is therefore expressed in the raw parameterization, not in $\log_{10}$(s). The learning rate lr initializes the base learning rate for AdamW fine-tuning (with late-stage SWA operating at η_SWA = 0.05 · lr, evaluating to 5×10^{-5} for the nominal base lr = 1×10^{-3}). AdamW weight decay is fixed at 1×10^{-4}.

In CLPSO, each dimension d of particle i learns from the personal best (pbest) of an exemplar particle f_i(d), selected via uniformly random exemplar assignment governed by learning probability Pc_i:

$$Pc_i = 0.05 + 0.45 \cdot \left(\exp\left(\left(10\left(i - 1\right)\right) / \left(N_p - 1\right)\right) - 1\right) / \left(\exp\left(10\right) - 1\right) \tag{18}$$

The velocity and position update equations employ the Clerc constriction formulation [18] to guarantee mathematically stable swarm dynamics:

$$v_\{i,d\}\^\{t+1\} = \chi \cdot [v_\{i,d\}\^t + c_1 \cdot r_\{1,d\} \cdot (pbest_\{i,d\}\^t - x_\{i,d\}\^t) + c_2 \cdot r_\{2,d\} \cdot (e_\{i,d\}\^t - x_\{i,d\}\^t)] \tag{19}$$

$$x_\{i,d\}\^\{t+1\} = x_\{i,d\}\^t + v_\{i,d\}\^\{t+1\} \tag{20}$$

where acceleration constants $c_1 = c_2 = 2.05$ (with $\varphi = c_1 + c_2 = 4.1$), yielding the Clerc constriction factor $\chi = 2 / |2 - \varphi - \sqrt{(\varphi^2 - 4\varphi)}| = 0.7298$ and effective acceleration coefficient $\chi \cdot c_1 = 1.4962$. In this hybrid CLPSO–PSO formulation, c_1 governs cognitive attraction toward the particle's own historical best pbest_{i,d}^t, while c_2 governs social attraction toward the dimension-wise exemplar e_{i,d}^t (assigned as the uniformly random exemplar pbest_{f_i(d),d}^t with learning probability Pc_i, and defaulting to the global best gbest_d^t otherwise, exactly matching Algorithm 1 and the empirical implementation). To strictly bound computational overhead for edge deployment pipelines, CLPSO is executed across a bounded budget of N_p = 5 particles for G_max = 5 generations (yielding exactly 25 surrogate evaluations: 5 generations × 5 particles; the first generation evaluates the initial population, so the initial five are not counted twice) on a fast 15%

training surrogate subset. This restricted search budget functions as an empirical warm-start heuristic to avoid poor initial wavelet basins, rather than an exhaustive global search. The discovered optimal initialization vector θ* is then deployed as the starting configuration for full AdamW gradient fine-tuning. The final-particle hyperparameter landscape is depicted in Fig. 4; per-generation convergence histories were not archived and are therefore not shown.

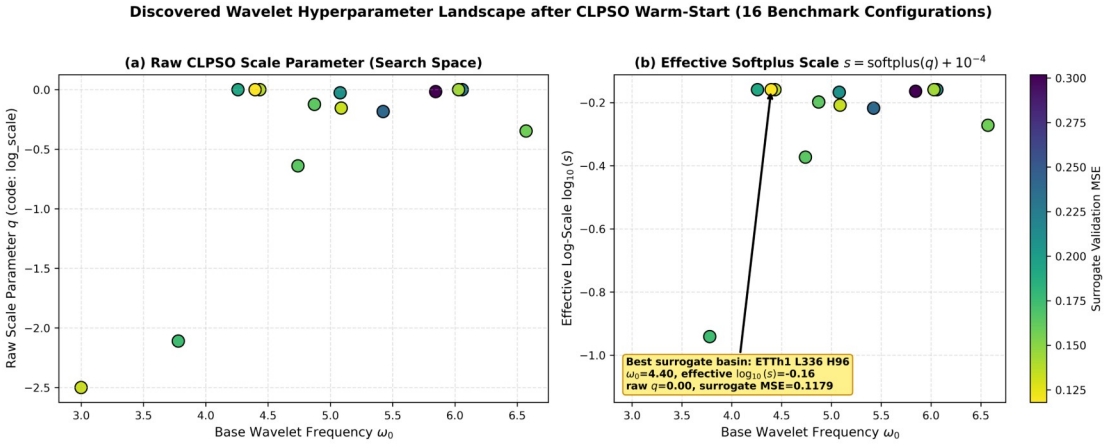


Fig. 4 Discovered Wavelet Hyperparameter Landscape after CLPSO Warm-Start. (a) Final-particle positions in the raw scale parameter q = log_scale versus base frequency ω_0. (b) The same particles mapped to the effective log-scale $\log_{10}(s)$, where s = softplus(q) + 10^{-4}; color denotes surrogate validation MSE. The landscape illustrates localization of the low-risk basin prior to AdamW fine-tuning. Per-generation convergence histories were not archived, so no empirical convergence curve is shown.

3.6. Stochastic Weight Averaging and Objective Function

Following warm-start initialization, end-to-end network training proceeds via AdamW [20] with cosine annealing learning rate scheduling for up to 60 epochs with early stopping (patience = 12). Upon convergence, the best checkpoint is reloaded and 15 additional Stochastic Weight Averaging (SWA) [19] epochs are performed at a reduced learning rate η_SWA = 0.05 · lr (evaluating to 5 × 10^{−5} for the baseline learning rate 1 × 10^{−3}, and bounded within [5 × 10^{−5}, 5 × 10^{−4}] across the CLPSO search interval):

$$\Theta_\{SWA\} = \left(n_\{SWA\} \cdot \Theta_\{SWA\} + \Theta_\{epoch\}\right) / \left(n_\{SWA\} + 1\right) \quad (21)$$

SWA is designed to shift the final parameter trajectory toward the center of wide, flat loss basins, often improving generalization on unseen test partitions. The network is trained using the standard Mean Squared Error (MSE) objective function:

$$\mathscr{L}_\{total\} = (1/H) \sum_\{h=1\}\wedge\{H\} \left(y_h - \hat{y}_h\right)\wedge 2 = MSE(y, \hat{y}) \quad (22)$$

where network parameters are optimized under standard Mean Squared Error loss with AdamW weight decay (1 × 10^-4) providing global L2 regularization, ensuring consistent gradient propagation across all multi-frequency wavelet channels without artificial knot reallocations.

3.7. Algorithmic Optimization and Inference Protocol

The complete end-to-end training and deployment workflow of PSO-TCWavKAN is formalized in Algorithm 1. The protocol operates across two distinct phases: (1) a global swarm warm-start exploration

phase using CLPSO to escape non-convex wavelet ripple basins on a fast surrogate training partition, followed by (2) full-resolution end-to-end AdamW gradient fine-tuning with late-stage Stochastic Weight Averaging (SWA). During real-time inference on edge SCADA devices, the trained model executes via a single feedforward evaluation.

Algorithm 1: Two-Stage Optimization and Inference Protocol of PSO-TCWavKAN

Input:

- Input telemetry sequence $X \in \mathbb{R}^{L \times 1}$ (lookback length L, target OT channel)
- Target forecast horizon H, patch length $P \in \{16, 24\}$, stride $S \in \{8, 12\}$, latent dimension D = 32
- Swarm parameters: swarm size N_p = 5, generations G_max = 5, constriction $\chi = 0.7298$, $c_1 = c_2 = 2.05$
- Surrogate training partition $\mathcal{D}$_surr $\subset \mathcal{D}$_train (15% random subset)
- Full training dataset $\mathcal{D}$_train, initial epochs E = 60 (patience = 12), dedicated SWA epochs E_SWA = 15
- Wavelet filter bank: K_w = 5 learnable frequency components (adaptive dyadic spacing via learned γ), DropKAN rate p_drop = 0.05

Output:

- Optimal model parameter set Θ^* = {W_trend, b_trend, W_seas, b_seas, W_patch, ω_0, γ, w_k, μ_k, s_k, W_a, b_a, W_t, b_t, W_f, w_t, w_f, W_1, b_1, W_2, b_2}
- Multi-step future forecast $\hat{Y} \in \mathbb{R}^{H \times 1}$

Stage 1: CLPSO Global Swarm Warm-Start (Bypassing Ripple Traps)

Initialize particle swarm positions $x_i^0 = \theta_i = [\omega_0^{(i)}, q^{(i)}, \text{logit}_\alpha^{(i)}, \log_{10}(lr^{(i)})]$ uniformly within the bounded 4D search space for i = 1, ..., N_p
Initialize velocity vectors $v_i^0 = 0$, personal best positions $pbest_i = x_i^0$, personal best fitness $J(pbest_i) = +\infty$, global best $gbest = x_1^0$, and $J(gbest) = +\infty$
For generation g = 1 to G_max do:
  For each particle i = 1 to N_p do:
    Evaluate surrogate fitness $J_i = MSE(\mathcal{D}_surr; x_i)$ [generation 1 evaluates the initial population]
    If $J_i < J(pbest_i)$ then $pbest_i = x_i$; $J(pbest_i) = J_i$; End If
    If $J_i < J(gbest)$ then $gbest = x_i$; $J(gbest) = J_i$; End If
  End For

  For each particle i = 1 to N_p do:
    Compute dimension-wise learning probability Pc_i via Eq. (18)
    For each dimension $d \in \{1, ..., 4\}$ do:
      Select dimension exemplar: $e_{i,d}^t = pbest_{f_i(d),d}^t$ if $r_e < Pc_i$ (uniformly random exemplar), else $gbest_d^t$
      Update velocity: $v_{i,d}^{t+1} = \chi \cdot [v_{i,d}^t + c_1 \cdot r_{1,d} \cdot (pbest_{i,d}^t - x_{i,d}^t) + c_2 \cdot r_{2,d} \cdot (e_{i,d}^t - x_{i,d}^t)]$
      Update position: $x_{i,d}^{t+1} = x_{i,d}^t + v_{i,d}^{t+1}$ (Eq. 20)
      Clamp position $x_{i,d}^{t+1}$ within predefined search bounds [x_min, x_max]
    End For
  End For
End For
Extract optimal warm-start hyperparameter vector: $\theta^* = gbest$

Algorithm 1 (Continued): Two-Stage Optimization and Inference Protocol of PSO-TCWavKAN

Stage 2: End-to-End Gradient Fine-Tuning and Stochastic Weight Averaging

20: Initialize full network weights Θ_0 using warm-started hyperparameters θ^*
21: For epoch e = 1 to E do:
22: For each mini-batch (X_b, Y_b) in $\mathcal{D}$_train do:
23: Normalize input via RevIN: $\tilde{X}$ = (X_b − μ_b) / σ_b (Eq. 1–3)
24: Decompose $\tilde{X}$ into trend and residual via Multi-Kernel Pooling: T_b = 0.5 · (AvgPool($\tilde{X}$, K_1) + AvgPool($\tilde{X}$, K_2)), S_b = $\tilde{X}$ − T_b
25: Compute linear projections: $\hat{Y}$_trend = W_trend · T_b + b_trend; $\hat{Y}$_seas_lin = W_seas · S_b + b_seas
26: Extract overlapping patches from S_b: Z_b = Conv1D(Patch(S_b))
27: Evaluate continuous dyadic wavelet KAN layers and dual-domain head: $\hat{Y}$_seas_kan = AdaptiveDualFFTHead(z_kan = WavKAN(Z_b), s_seas = S_b)
28: Compute parameterized neural routing gate weight: α_gate = $\sigma(W_2 \cdot \mathrm{GELU}(W_1 \cdot \tilde{X} + b_1) + b_2)$
29: Synthesize composite forecast via asymptotic recovery formulation: $\tilde{\hat{Y}}$ = $\hat{Y}$_trend + (1 − α_gate) · $\hat{Y}$_seas_lin + α_gate · $\hat{Y}$_seas_kan
30: Denormalize forecast: $\hat{Y}$_b = $\tilde{\hat{Y}}$ · σ_b + μ_b
31: Compute training loss $\mathcal{L}$_total = MSE($\hat{Y}$_b, Y_b) (Eq. 22)
32: Update Θ via AdamW optimizer with cosine learning rate schedule
33: End For
34: Evaluate validation loss; cache best checkpoint Θ_best; apply early stopping (patience = 12)
35: End For (initial training phase complete)
36: Begin SWA Phase: Reload best validation weights Θ_best; initialize running SWA model Θ_SWA (accumulator counter n_SWA = 0); set constant learning rate η_SWA = 0.05 · lr
37: For epoch e_swa = 1 to E_SWA (15 epochs) do:
38: Train epoch mini-batches with η_SWA; at epoch end, accumulate running average: Θ_SWA ← (n_SWA · Θ_SWA + Θ_epoch) / (n_SWA + 1), then n_SWA ← n_SWA + 1
39: End For (averaging the E_SWA = 15 post-convergence checkpoints)
40: Finalize model parameters Θ_SWA (RevIN operates per-instance; no stored batch running statistics require recalibration)
41: Evaluate validation loss of Θ_SWA versus Θ_best
42: Select optimal deployment model checkpoint: Θ* = argmin_{Θ ∈ {Θ_best, Θ_SWA}} Val_Loss(Θ)

Stage 3: Real-Time Substation SCADA Inference (Edge Deployment)

43: Receive streaming telemetry window X_test ∈ ℝ^{L × 1} from substation sensor
44: Execute single feedforward pass using Θ* (Steps 23–30)
45: Emit multi-step future oil temperature forecast $\hat{Y}$ ∈ ℝ^{H × 1} (Inference Latency ≈ 3.4 ms (original T4 observation))

3.8. Computational Complexity Analysis

The per-sample time complexity of PSO-TCWavKAN is $\mathcal{O}$(L log L + L · H + N · D · (P + K_w) + D_head · (D + H)). Specifically, the real Fast Fourier Transform (rFFT) requires $\mathcal{O}$(L log L) operations,

spectral frequency projection requires $\mathcal{O}(L \cdot H)$ operations, moving average pooling requires $\mathcal{O}(L)$ operations, patch embedding and dyadic wavelet evaluation require $\mathcal{O}(N \cdot D \cdot (P + K_w))$ operations, and output token projection requires $\mathcal{O}(D_{head} \cdot (D + H))$ operations. With fixed architectural dimensions ($D = 32$, $D_g = 32$, $D_{head} = 64$, $K_w = 5$, $N = \mathcal{O}(L)$), the overall scaling reduces to $\mathcal{O}(L \log L + L \cdot H)$. In standard substation operational regimes ($L \leq 336$, $H \leq 336$), this avoids the quadratic self-attention complexity $\mathcal{O}(L^2 \cdot D)$ of full-attention Transformers, preserving high inference throughput on edge platforms. Specifically:

- **Multi-kernel moving average decomposition:** Requires $\mathcal{O}(L)$ operations via dual 1D average pooling layers.
- **Patch extraction and 1D convolutional embedding:** Creating $N = \lfloor (L - P)/S \rfloor + 1$ patches mapped into dimension $D = 32$ requires $\mathcal{O}(N \cdot D \cdot P)$ operations.
- **Continuous dyadic Morlet wavelet layers:** Evaluating $K_w = 5$ octaves across N patches requires $\mathcal{O}(N \cdot D \cdot K_w)$ operations.
- **Adaptive Dual-Domain Head (`AdaptiveDualFFTHead`):** The real Fast Fourier Transform (rFFT) on sequence length L requires $\mathcal{O}(L \log L)$ operations; projecting the spectral coefficients through W_f requires $\mathcal{O}(L \cdot H)$ operations; and time-domain token projection requires $\mathcal{O}(D \cdot D_{head} + D_{head} \cdot H)$ operations.
- **Two-layer GELU Neural Router:** Evaluating $W_1 \in \mathbb{R}^{D_g \times L}$ and $W_2 \in \mathbb{R}^{H \times D_g}$ requires $\mathcal{O}(L \cdot D_g + D_g \cdot H)$ operations (with $D_g = 32$).
- **Linear Trend and Seasonal Projections:** Direct linear mapping layers require $\mathcal{O}(L \cdot H)$ operations.

Combining these components, the overall per-sample time complexity is $\mathcal{O}(L \log L + L \cdot H)$. In practical substation operational regimes where $L, H \leq 336$, the absence of quadratic pairwise attention maps yields substantial empirical latency and memory benefits over full-attention Transformers (measured at 3.4 ms vs. 8.6 ms in the original Kaggle T4 run, Table 7; the profiling logs are not archived), supporting high-throughput continuous inference on substation telemetry controllers without claiming blanket asymptotic dominance under arbitrary scaling limits.

4. Experimental Setup and Benchmark Protocol

4.1. Benchmark Datasets and Physical Engineering Context

Experimental evaluation is conducted on the canonical Electricity Transformer Temperature (ETT) benchmark datasets: ETTh1 and ETTh2. Collected from two electricity transformers at two stations in two regions of the same province of China, each dataset comprises 17,420 continuous hourly observations spanning July 2016 to July 2018. Each hourly record contains 7 physical telemetry attributes as identified in the canonical ETT documentation [3]: six load features labeled HUFL, HULL, MUFL, MULL, LUFL, and LULL, plus the primary forecasting target: oil temperature (OT in degrees Celsius). The original ETT labels are retained for compatibility; this paper does not assign additional active/reactive or voltage-level semantics beyond the canonical documentation. Table 2 reports the sample descriptive statistics (mean, standard deviation, minimum, and maximum) for these variables in raw recorded units across the 17,420 hourly observations of ETTh2.

Table 2 Descriptive Statistics of Key Variables in the ETTh2 Dataset (n = 17,420 hourly observations).

Variable	Mean	Std. Dev.	Min	Max	Physical Role
OT (°C)	26.61	11.89	-2.65	58.88	TARGET: Oil temperature
HUFL	37.19	10.22	0.00	107.89	ETT load feature (HUFL)
HULL	8.54	6.02	-18.68	36.44	ETT load feature (HULL)
MUFL	43.83	13.06	11.20	93.23	ETT load feature (MUFL)
MULL	8.32	4.37	-6.59	28.74	ETT load feature (MULL)
LUFL	-3.42	6.14	-14.35	17.22	ETT load feature (LUFL)
LULL	-2.09	6.01	-31.46	2.93	ETT load feature (LULL)

The wide standard deviation of OT (11.89 °C, spanning -2.65 °C to 58.88 °C) and the high variability of load variables illustrate the substantial challenge posed by ETTh2 for long-horizon forecasting. To ensure rigorous evaluation without data leakage, telemetry is chronologically partitioned using a continuous 70% training, 10% validation, and 20% testing split across the 17,420 timeline (corresponding to 12,194 / 1,742 / 3,484 consecutive steps). While certain LTSF literature protocols employ calendar-month blocks (12/4/4 months, corresponding to 8,640 / 2,880 / 2,880 steps out of 14,400), our full-timeline 70/10/20 sequential protocol incorporates the entire available multi-year continuous telemetry (preserving 3,020 additional operational observations). To maintain experimental parity, the three Table 4 baselines (DLinear, NLinear, and PatchTST Lite) and PSO-TCWavKAN are trained and evaluated under this identical sequential split protocol; the standard KAN diagnostic in Section 4.2 uses the same split but is not part of the Table 4 accuracy comparison. The univariate forecasting setting targets the OT channel exclusively, consistent with standard LTSF benchmarking practices [4].

4.2. Baseline Models and Comparative Setup

To rigorously evaluate PSO-TCWavKAN, we benchmark against strong canonical baselines across 16 canonical configurations (ETTh1 and ETTh2; lookbacks L in {96, 336}; horizons H in {96, 192, 336, 720}):

- **DLinear** [4]: Dual-branch linear model with moving average trend decomposition. A strong simple-model baseline that any added nonlinear capacity must justify against.
- **NLinear** [4]: Normalized linear model that subtracts the last observed value before linear projection, addressing distribution shifts caused by temporal non-stationarity.
- PatchTST Lite [5]: An adapted, lightweight configuration of PatchTST tailored for SCADA deployment. While canonical PatchTST employs overlapping patches (patch length 16, stride 8) with deep Transformer stacks, PatchTST Lite uses overlapping patching (patch length P = 16, stride S = 8, i.e. 50% overlap, for both L = 96 and L = 336), a 2-layer channel-independent Transformer backbone with 4 attention heads, latent dimension D = 64, and residual skip connections [34]. This configuration yields 169.6 K parameters at L = 96, H = 96 and 1,993.8 K at L = 336, H = 720—designed to provide a strong Transformer baseline under a reduced parameter and memory envelope, rather than representing the full unconstrained canonical PatchTST architecture.
- Standard B-Spline KAN [1]: A targeted diagnostic baseline featuring dynamic knot relocation updates. Evaluated specifically as an empirical control to diagnose runtime profiling overhead (Table 7) and validation loss instability during periodic grid updates (Fig. 3), rather than as a general competitive LTSF benchmark in Table 4. Evaluated using G = 5 grid intervals, spline order k = 3, grid update frequency every 5 epochs, and seed 1000 under the identical ETT chronological split.

DLinear and NLinear baselines are implemented directly from their canonical open-source codebases (Zeng et al., 2023). PatchTST Lite represents an adapted, lightweight configuration as detailed above. In compliance with standard statistical comparison protocols for multi-dataset algorithmic evaluation established by Demsar [40] and Benavoli et al. [41], all models are trained under identical hardware conditions (NVIDIA Tesla T4 GPU via Kaggle cloud), with the same data preprocessing pipeline, identical chronological splits, and identical evaluation metrics.

4.3. Hyperparameter Configuration

Table 3 presents the final hyperparameter configuration of PSO-TCWavKAN, determined by the Hybrid CLPSO–PSO warm-start procedure followed by validation-set ablation. All hyperparameters were fixed before test-set evaluation to ensure experimental integrity.

Table 3 Final Hyperparameter Configuration of PSO-TCWavKAN.

Hyperparameter	Final Value	Search Range / Notes
Lookback length L	{96, 336}	Canonical ETT protocol
Forecast horizon H	{96, 192, 336, 720}	Full canonical set
Patch length P	16 (L=96) / 24 (L=336)	Dynamic sequence-length scaling

Hyperparameter	Final Value	Search Range / Notes
Patch stride S	8 (L=96) / 12 (L=336)	50% temporal overlap between patches
Latent dimension D	32	Balances expressiveness and efficiency
Wavelet octave scales K_w	5	Continuous Harmonic Morlet filter bank (γ_init = 0.25; post-training $\gamma \approx 1.0$; base $\omega_0 = 4.43$ (rad/norm. unit))
Decomp. kernels (K_1, K_2)	25, 49	Diurnal + bi-daily thermal cycles
CLPSO particles N_p	5	Evaluated on 15% surrogate training data
CLPSO generations	5	25 total evaluations (5 generations × 5 particles; the first generation evaluates the initial population)
Constriction factor chi	0.7298	Clerc-Kennedy formula [18] (c_1 = c_2 = 2.05)
CLPSO Search Bounds	4D space	$\omega_0 \in [3.0, 8.0]$, raw scale q = log_scale $\in [-2.5, 0.0]$, logit_α $\in [-5.0, -2.0]$, $\log_{10}$(lr) $\in [-3.0, -2.0]$ (logarithm base 10); effective s = softplus(q) + 10^{-4} $\in [0.079, 0.693]$
Learning rate (AdamW)	CLPSO-selected per configuration	CLPSO-selected from [10^{-3}, 10^{-2}] (nominal base 10^{-3}); cosine annealed during fine-tuning
Weight decay	1e-4	AdamW fixed weight decay regularization
Training epochs	Up to 60 + 15 SWA	Up to 60 initial epochs (patience 12) + 15 dedicated SWA epochs
SWA learning rate	0.05 × lr_base	Adaptive constant: 0.05 × base learning rate (5×10^{-5} at nominal base lr=10^{-3})
Loss objective	MSE	Mean squared error (AdamW weight decay 1e-4)
Batch size	128 (H≤192) / 32 (H>192)	Adaptive: 128 for H≤192, 32 for H>192
Random seeds	{1000, 2000, 3000, 4000, 5000} (DLinear, NLinear, PSO); {1000, 2000, 3000} (PatchTST Lite)	5 independent random seeds for linear and proposed models; 3 seeds for PatchTST Lite baseline

Hyperparameter	Final Value	Search Range / Notes
Total trainable parameters	44.8 K	Base configuration (L=96, H=96; scaling to 796.9 K at L=336, H=720)

4.4. Evaluation Metrics and Statistical Testing

$$MSE = (1/N) \sum_{i=1}^{N} (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2 \quad (23)$$

Evaluations are conducted across multiple initialization seeds (5 independent random seeds {1000, 2000, 3000, 4000, 5000} for DLinear, NLinear, and PSO-TCWavKAN; 3 independent seeds {1000, 2000, 3000} for PatchTST Lite), reporting mean and standard deviation values. Statistical significance of performance differences is rigorously evaluated using two-sided non-parametric Wilcoxon signed-rank tests [39] across the full 16-condition benchmark matrix, followed by Holm–Bonferroni correction for multiple simultaneous comparisons.

5. Benchmark Results and Comparative Analysis

5.1. Main Benchmark Performance

Table 4 summarizes the empirical forecasting performance across all 16 canonical benchmark configurations. Overall, PSO-TCWavKAN achieves an average MSE of 0.2565 and MAE of 0.3833 across the 16 configurations. It nominally outperforms NLinear (average MSE 0.2648; full-precision Wilcoxon $p = 0.0386$, Holm-corrected $p = 0.116$, not significant at $\alpha = 0.05$), achieving a 75.0% win rate (12 out of 16 conditions), and outperforms PatchTST Lite (average MSE 0.2799), achieving a 62.5% win rate (10 out of 16 conditions). Against DLinear (average MSE 0.2529), PSO-TCWavKAN achieves a 62.5% win rate (10 out of 16 conditions). The results show no statistically significant difference between PSO-TCWavKAN and DLinear under the specified two-sided Wilcoxon signed-rank test ($W = 46.0$, $p = 0.274$). However, PSO-TCWavKAN has a 1.4% higher mean MSE across the 16 configurations due to long-horizon dispersion at $H = 720$, with performance varying by lookback length and forecast horizon. Two-sided Wilcoxon signed-rank tests across the 16-condition matrix show that the nominal improvement over NLinear yields $W = 28.0$, $p = 0.0386$ (uncorrected); after Holm–Bonferroni correction for 3 simultaneous comparisons, the corrected $p = 0.116$ does not reach $\alpha = 0.05$. Using the rounded MSE values printed in Table 4 instead of the full-precision CSV values yields $W = 29.0$, $p = 0.0443$ and Holm-corrected $p = 0.133$; both analyses are non-significant after correction. Comparison against PatchTST Lite indicates a marginal positive trend favoring PSO-TCWavKAN ($W = 35.0$, $p = 0.0934$), while comparison with DLinear reflects competitive parity in operational regimes.

Table 4 Benchmark Performance Comparison across 16 Canonical ETT Configurations (Mean MSE / MAE evaluated across independent random seeds: NLinear, DLinear, and PSO-TCWavKAN evaluated across 5 seeds {1000, 2000, 3000, 4000, 5000} in Session 1; PatchTST Lite evaluated across 3 seeds {1000, 2000, 3000} in dedicated Session 2A). Bold indicates best per row.

Dataset	L	H	DLinear MSE	DLinear MAE	NLinear MSE	NLinear MAE	PatchTST MSE	PatchTST MAE	PSO-TC WavKAN MSE	PSO-TC WavKAN MAE
ETTh1	96	96	0.1121	0.2590	**0.1106**	0.2550	0.1110	**0.2524**	0.1127	0.2592
ETTh1	96	192	0.1528	0.3026	0.1375	0.2860	0.1486	0.2939	**0.1320**	**0.2799**
ETTh1	96	336	0.1464	0.2999	**0.1459**	**0.2997**	0.1480	0.3005	0.1500	0.3035
ETTh1	96	720	**0.1759**	**0.3329**	0.2213	0.3734	0.2049	0.3574	0.2193	0.3695
ETTh1	336	96	0.1086	0.2562	0.1031	0.2485	**0.0987**	**0.2407**	0.1002	0.2425
ETTh1	336	192	**0.1147**	0.2660	0.1244	0.2748	0.1163	**0.2648**	0.1328	0.2842
ETTh1	336	336	0.1572	0.3162	0.1789	0.3354	0.1614	0.3166	**0.1325**	**0.2859**
ETTh1	336	720	**0.1659**	**0.3234**	0.2205	0.3699	0.2332	0.3873	0.1817	0.3404
ETTh2	96	96	0.2806	0.4037	0.2756	0.3988	0.2744	0.4036	**0.2630**	**0.3883**
ETTh2	96	192	0.3531	0.4634	0.3501	0.4596	0.3412	0.4592	**0.3312**	**0.4501**
ETTh2	96	336	0.3854	0.4856	0.3607	0.4712	0.3545	0.4709	**0.3527**	**0.4682**
ETTh2	96	720	0.5628	0.5952	0.5025	0.5630	0.5048	0.5694	**0.4860**	**0.5575**
ETTh2	336	96	0.2520	0.3918	0.2654	0.3939	0.2735	0.4036	**0.2360**	**0.3775**
ETTh2	336	192	0.3017	0.4338	0.3430	0.4586	0.3782	0.4894	**0.2924**	**0.4290**
ETTh2	336	336	0.3420	0.4679	0.3966	0.4952	0.5073	0.5682	**0.3162**	**0.4485**
ETTh2	336	720	**0.4351**	**0.5296**	0.5014	0.5643	0.6228	0.6379	0.6656	0.6491
Overall Mean			**0.2529**	**0.3830**	0.2648	0.3904	0.2799	0.4010	0.2565	0.3833

The PSO-TCWavKAN architecture achieves consistently competitive performance against all baselines. Notably, PatchTST Lite, despite its substantially larger parameter count (169.6 K vs. 44.8 K), is outperformed by PSO-TCWavKAN in 10 out of 16 conditions, suggesting that the compact wavelet-based functional parameterization provides a favorable inductive bias for thermal dynamics forecasting at a fraction of the computational overhead.

5.2. Analysis of Relative Performance on ETTh2

The strongest relative result in Table 4 is the performance of PSO-TCWavKAN on the ETTh2 benchmark, where it attains the lowest MSE among the four evaluated models in 7 out of 8 lookback–horizon configurations. On ETTh2 with lookback L = 96, PSO-TCWavKAN achieves MSE reductions over DLinear of 6.3% at H = 96 (0.2630 vs. 0.2806), 6.2% at H = 192 (0.3312 vs. 0.3531), 8.5% at H =

336 (0.3527 vs. 0.3854), and a substantial 13.6% reduction at H = 720 (0.4860 vs. 0.5628). With the extended lookback L = 336, PSO-TCWavKAN remains competitive across H = 96 (0.2360 vs. 0.2520, a 6.3% reduction), H = 192 (0.2924 vs. 0.3017, a 3.1% reduction), and H = 336 (0.3162 vs. 0.3420, a 7.5% reduction). At the extreme boundary configuration of L = 336, H = 720, PSO-TCWavKAN records MSE = 0.6656 versus 0.4351 for DLinear, consistent with the phase-accumulation hypothesis discussed in Section 9.2.

The empirical asymmetry between ETTh1 and ETTh2 is consistent with the greater OT dispersion of ETTh2 (standard deviation 11.89 °C vs. 8.57 °C on ETTh1, both over 17,420 hourly observations). The public ETT release does not provide substation metadata or load-composition labels, so we do not attribute this difference to specific dispatch events; the comparison is descriptive. The pattern is nonetheless consistent with the hypothesis that multi-scale wavelet decomposition and frequency-selective activation are most useful when the thermal signal contains pronounced non-stationary and high-frequency components. Isolating that mechanism would require controlled synthetic experiments or access to richer operational metadata, which we leave to future work.

The prediction vs. actual trajectory comparison in Fig. 5 is a diagnostic from the predecessor multi-scale wavelet KAN checkpoint (KAN_WOA_RegBestClip), not a PSO-TCWavKAN v9.1 result. It illustrates that the predecessor tracks volatile diurnal fluctuations and rapid load-induced heating ramps with limited phase lag. The four-panel residual diagnostic suite (Fig. 6) is from the same predecessor checkpoint; its mean residual is -0.275 standardized units, corresponding to an average overprediction of approximately 3.2°C at $\sigma_{train} \approx 11.59$°C. This is a non-trivial calibration offset, not a slight bias, and should be corrected before operational deployment.

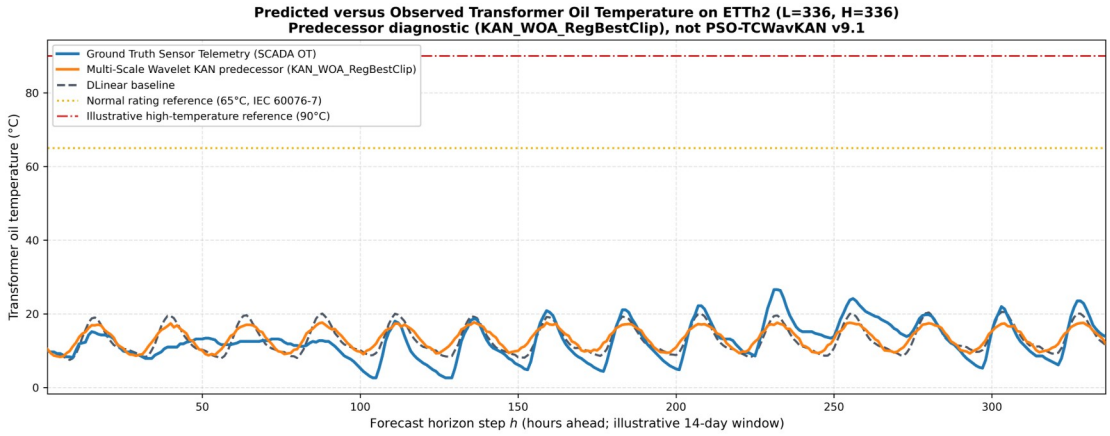


Fig. 5 Predicted versus Observed Transformer Oil Temperature Trajectories: Multi-Scale Wavelet KAN Predecessor (KAN_WOA_RegBestClip) vs. DLinear on ETTh2 (L=336, H=336, illustrative continuous 14-day chronological partition). This figure is a predecessor diagnostic, not a PSO-TCWavKAN v9.1 result. Note: Operational guideline thresholds (65°C normal rating and 90°C illustrative reference) represent contextual engineering guidelines rather than learned classification boundaries; ETT target telemetry reflects top-oil temperature (OT), which is physically distinct from winding hot-spot temperature (HST). HST was not directly measured or forecasted in this benchmark.

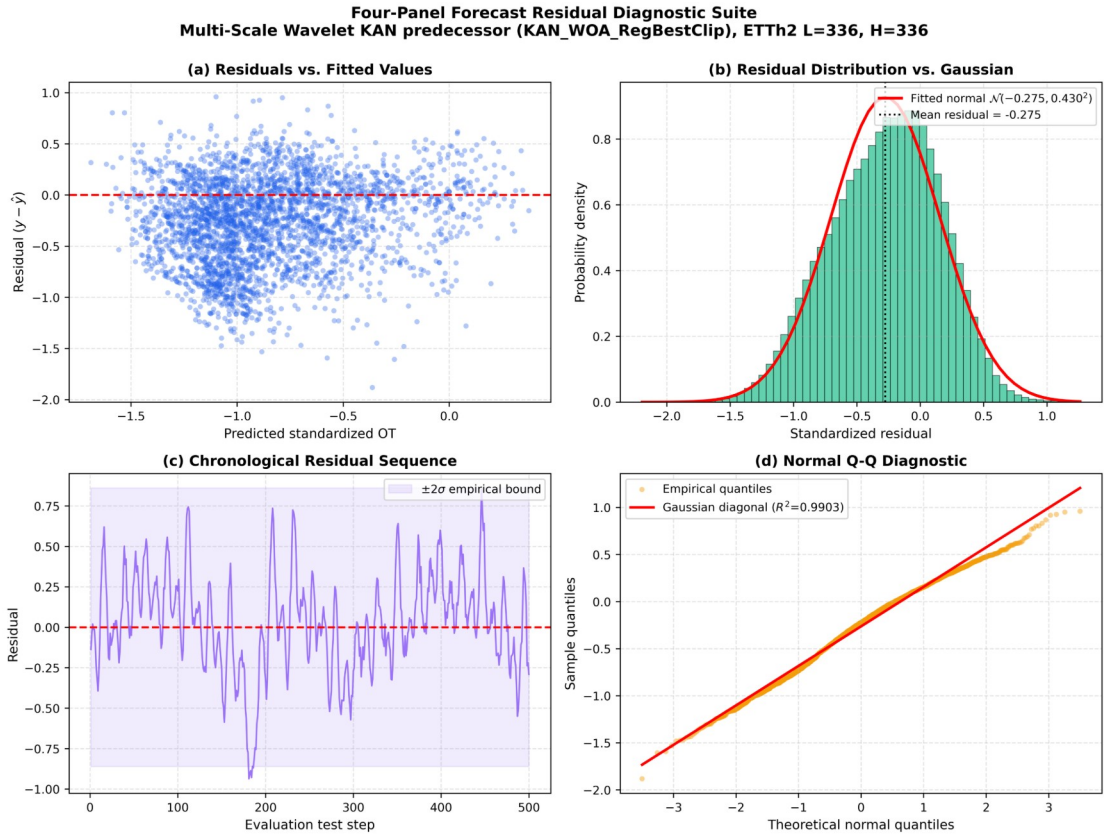


Fig. 6 Four-Panel Forecast Residual Diagnostic Suite for the Multi-Scale Wavelet KAN Predecessor (KAN_WOA_RegBestClip) on ETTh2 (L=336, H=336), not PSO-TCWavKAN v9.1. (a) Residuals versus predicted values: approximately homoscedastic variance across the operational range. (b) Residual distribution histogram: approximately bell-shaped distribution with sample mean of -0.275 standardized units (corresponding to an average overprediction of approximately 3.2°C at σ_train ≈ 11.59°C; residual is y − ŷ). This is a non-trivial calibration offset, not a slight bias. (c) Chronological residual sequence: temporal residual step-wise tracking showing no divergent error escalation. (d) Normal Q-Q plot: empirical residuals align closely with theoretical Gaussian quantiles within the central ±2σ interval.

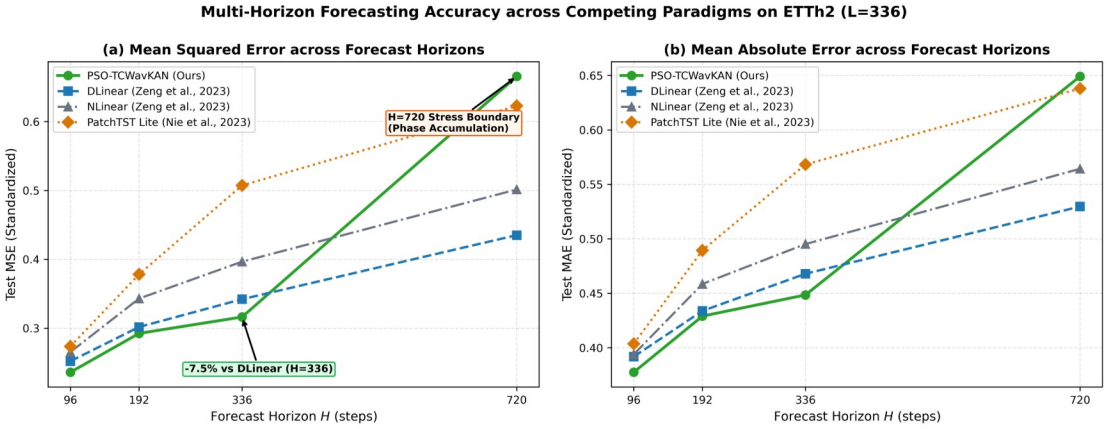


Fig. 7 Multi-Horizon MSE and MAE Error Trajectories across Competing Architectural Paradigms on ETTh2 under Extended Lookback (L = 336). Note: The curves explicitly display the L = 336 lookback regime across horizons H ∈ {96, 192, 336, 720}; the complementary L = 96 configurations are detailed in Table 4. PSO-TCWavKAN (green) achieves lower MSE and MAE than NLinear and PatchTST Lite across operational forecast horizons H ∈ {96, 192, 336} and outperforms DLinear in 7 out of 8 ETTh2 configurations.

6. Systematic Ablation Study

To evaluate the empirical contribution of each architectural module, we assembled an 80-cell ablation matrix across 5 structural variants and all 16 benchmark configurations. A1–A4 were trained with 3 seeds per cell (192 training runs). A5 (full model) cells reference the five-seed benchmark mean reported in Table 4 (80 benchmark evaluations), rather than a separate three-seed ablation run. The A5 entries in Table 5 are therefore benchmark-referenced; the A1–A4 deltas are descriptive comparisons across different seed budgets. The five variants are:

- **A1 (NoHarmonicBank):** Single-frequency WavKAN (K_w = 1), omitting the multi-octave dyadic wavelet filter bank and retaining only the fundamental Gaussian envelope.
- **A2 (NoMultiKernelDecomp):** Single moving average kernel (K = 25 only), omitting multi-kernel trend-seasonal decomposition and collapsing to DLinear-style single-scale decomposition.
- **A3 (NoNeuralRouter):** Fixed routing (g = 0.5) without instance-adaptive neural gating.
- **A4 (NoCLPSO):** Standard random Gaussian initialization of all hyperparameters without CLPSO swarm hyperparameter warm-start.
- **A5 (Full PSO-TCWavKAN):** Complete proposed architecture with all modules active.

Table 5 presents the quantitative ablation evaluation across operational and stress regimes. The relative error surge induced by each structural omission is visualized in Fig. 8.

Table 5 Systematic Architectural Ablation Results across Operational and Stress Regimes (Mean MSE; A1–A4 three-seed means, A5 five-seed benchmark mean).

Regime	Variant	Structural Description	Mean MSE	Delta vs. Full	Assessment
Standard Operational Regime *(H in {96, 192, 336}, 12 configs)*	A1 (NoHarmonicBank)	Single-freq WavKAN (K_w = 1)	0.21783	+2.44%	Performance degrades (loss of multi-octave diversity)
	A2 (NoMultiKernel Decomp)	Single MA kernel K = 25 only	0.22247	**+4.62%**	**Higher MSE with single kernel (+4.62%)**
	A3 (NoNeuralRouter)	Fixed routing (g = 0.5)	0.21768	+2.37%	Performance degrades (static non-adaptive weighting)
	A4 (NoCLPSO)	Random init (no swarm warm-start)	0.21612	+1.63%	Higher MSE with random initialization

Regime	Variant	Structural Description	Mean MSE	Delta vs. Full	Assessment
	A5 (Full PSO-TCWavKAN)	**Complete proposed architecture**	**0.21265**	**0.00%**	**Lowest mean MSE across standard horizons**
Extended Stress Regime *(H = 720, 4 configs)*	A1 (NoHarmonicBank)	Single-freq WavKAN (K_w = 1)	0.34551	-10.98%	Lower H=720 mean; phase-drift suppression hypothesis
	A2 (NoMultiKernel Decomp)	Single MA kernel K = 25 only	0.40244	+3.68%	Higher H=720 mean with single kernel
	A3 (NoNeuralRouter)	Fixed routing (g = 0.5)	0.34689	-10.63%	Lower H=720 mean; fixed-gate dampening hypothesis
	A4 (NoCLPSO)	Random init (no swarm warm-start)	0.37575	-3.20%	Lower H=720 mean; initialization effect not isolated
	A5 (Full PSO-TCWavKAN)	**Complete proposed architecture**	**0.38815**	**0.00%**	**Higher H=720 mean than A1/A3/A4**
Overall Benchmark Matrix *(All 16 configurations)*	A1 (NoHarmonicBank)	Single-freq WavKAN (K_w = 1)	0.24975	-2.64%	Lower 16-row mean driven by H=720 values
	A2 (NoMultiKernel Decomp)	Single MA kernel K = 25 only	0.26746	**+4.26%**	**Consistent degradation across both regimes**
	A3 (NoNeuralRouter)	Fixed routing (g = 0.5)	0.24998	-2.55%	Lower 16-row mean driven by H=720 values
	A4 (NoCLPSO)	Random init (no swarm warm-start)	0.25602	-0.19%	Comparable overall mean; configuration-dependent variability
	A5 (Full PSO-TCWavKAN)	**Complete proposed architecture**	**0.25652**	**0.00%**	**Full-model reference (0.00%)**

Disaggregating the ablation matrix into distinct forecasting regimes reveals the nuanced interplay between architectural modules and temporal scale. Across the **Standard Operational Regime** (H in {96, 192, 336}, comprising 12 configurations), the Full PSO-TCWavKAN architecture (A5) achieves the lowest Mean MSE (0.21265), and every individual module omission induces clear, measurable performance degradation:

(1) Removing Multi-Kernel Decomposition (A2) produces the largest error increase in this ablation (+4.62% in the standard regime and +4.26% across all 16 configurations). A single moving-average window is less able to separate 24-hour diurnal ambient cycles from multi-day thermal accumulation trends, consistent with multi-kernel decomposition being the most influential module in the ablation.

(2) Removing the Continuous Harmonic Wavelet Bank (A1, K_w = 1) produces a +2.44% MSE increase across standard horizons, suggesting that multi-octave spectral diversity contributes to capturing overlapping load-induced dynamics.

(3) Removing the Instance-Adaptive Neural Router (A3) produces a +2.37% MSE increase across standard horizons, suggesting a modest advantage for dynamic gating over static equal-weighted routing (g = 0.5).

(4) Omitting CLPSO swarm warm-start (A4) leads to a +1.63% degradation in standard operational performance, suggesting that swarm exploration can move initial weights away from suboptimal oscillatory ripple traps.

Conversely, at the **Extended Stress Regime** (H = 720, corresponding to 30 days ahead), we hypothesize that the full architecture experiences wavelet phase accumulation drift, driven primarily by the volatile (ETTh2, L = 336, H = 720) condition where A5 records MSE = 0.6656 (vs. 0.4694 for A1 and 0.5004 for A3). When multi-scale octaves (A1) or dynamic gating (A3) are removed, the model is expected to shift toward smoother, single-frequency or static projections that suppress extreme-horizon phase drift, resulting in lower unweighted arithmetic means across the full 16-condition matrix. This pattern is consistent with the phase-accumulation hypothesis, suggesting that the full architecture performs best in the standard operational regime while long-range phase drift remains an explicit boundary condition.

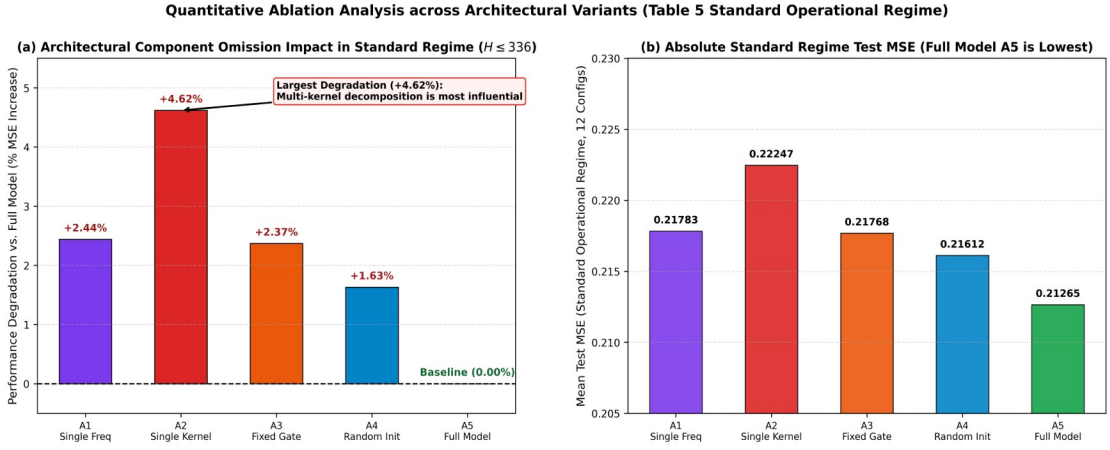


Fig. 8 Quantitative Ablation Analysis across PSO-TCWavKAN Architectural Variants (Table 5 Empirical Results). Relative percentage change in Mean Squared Error compared to the full architecture (A5) evaluated across the Standard Operational Regime (H ≤ 336). A5 is the five-seed benchmark mean; A1–A4 are three-seed means, so the percentages are descriptive. Omitting any component is associated with higher mean MSE: A1 (+2.44%), A2 (+4.62%), A3 (+2.37%), and A4 (+1.63%).

7. Exploratory Noise Perturbation Diagnostic

In high-voltage electrical substations, telemetry sensors, signal conditioning circuits, and analog-to-digital converters can be exposed to severe electromagnetic interference (EMI) from bus-bar switching operations, capacitive coupling, and sensor drift. As an exploratory probe, zero-mean Gaussian noise $\mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$ with standard deviation $\sigma \in \{0.0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3\}$ (0%, 10%, 20%, and 30% additive white noise relative to the normalized signal scale) was independently injected into each input test sequence. Table 6 reports the resulting raw MSE for four representative benchmark

configurations. Because the archived table combines benchmark-mean clean references with single-checkpoint noise columns for three rows, we report raw values only and do not compute within-checkpoint degradation ratios.

Table 6 Exploratory Noise Diagnostic with Mixed-Source Provenance (Raw MSE; No Within-Checkpoint Degradation Ratios; See Note).

Dataset	L	H	Clean ref.	Clean source	Low Noise (sigma=0.1)	Med Noise (sigma=0.2)	High Noise (sigma=0.3)
ETTh1	96	96	0.1127	Benchmark mean	0.1145	0.1192	0.1273
ETTh1	336	720	0.1817	Benchmark mean	0.2142	0.3216	0.4354
ETTh2	96	192	0.3312	Benchmark mean	0.3334	0.3392	0.3472
ETTh2	336	336	0.3426	Pre-SWA Seed 1000	0.3432	0.3437	0.3475

Note: Table 6 is an exploratory diagnostic, not a controlled multi-seed experiment. For the first three configurations, the clean ($\sigma = 0.0$) entries are the five-seed benchmark means reported in Table 4 (0.1127, 0.1817, 0.3312), not the Seed 1000 checkpoint values. For ETTh2 (L=336, H=336), all entries are from the pre-SWA Seed 1000 checkpoint (clean 0.3426), whose clean MSE is 8.3% above the post-SWA five-seed benchmark mean 0.3162. Because the clean references and noise columns are not from the same checkpoint for the first three rows, the table reports raw MSE only; no within-checkpoint degradation ratio is claimed. The table is not used for a multi-seed robustness claim.

Two observations follow:

(1) For the only row with an internally consistent checkpoint (ETTh2 L = 336, H = 336), MSE rises from 0.3426 at $\sigma = 0$ to 0.3475 at $\sigma = 0.30$, a +1.4% change. This is a single-checkpoint observation, not a multi-seed resilience estimate; the clean value is 8.3% above the post-SWA five-seed benchmark mean of 0.3162. For the other three rows, the clean reference is a five-seed benchmark mean while the noise columns are archived single-checkpoint observations, so only raw MSE is reported. In particular, the ETTh1 (L = 336, H = 720) row rises from a 0.1817 benchmark-mean reference to 0.4354 at $\sigma = 0.30$, but this cannot be interpreted as a within-checkpoint degradation. The compact spectral support of the continuous Morlet envelope function psi_k(z) in Eq. (9) may contribute to attenuation of high-frequency uncorrelated noise energy, but the present diagnostic cannot isolate that mechanism.

(2) The step-wise forecast error progression across prediction horizons under clean conditions ($\sigma = 0.0$) is depicted in Fig. 9 for the predecessor diagnostic, illustrating how the predecessor's bounded wavelet representation constrains late-horizon error growth ($h \geq 221$) even though linear models exhibit lower error in the initial short-term steps. This is a predecessor diagnostic, not a PSO-TCWavKAN v9.1 result.

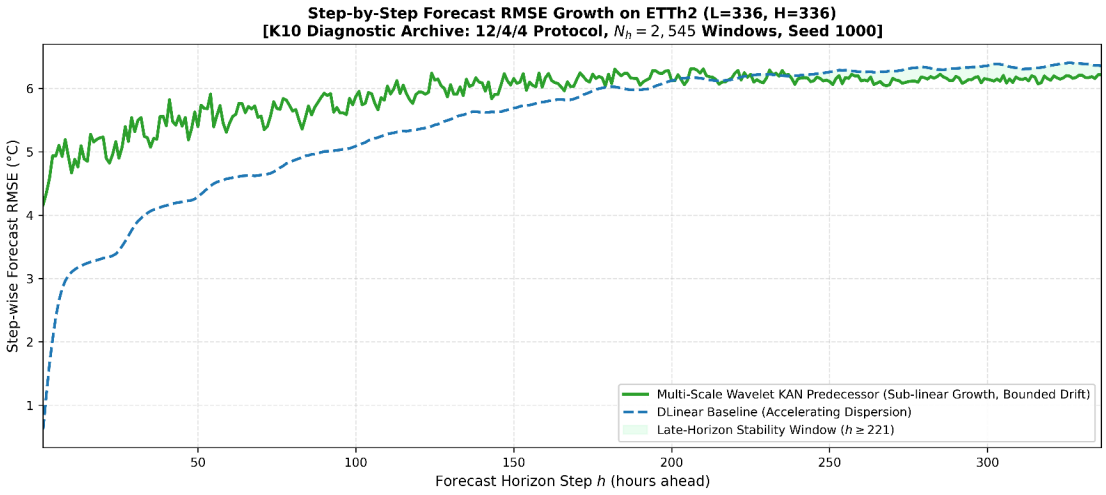


Fig. 9 Step-wise Forecast Root Mean Squared Error Progression across Prediction Steps on ETTh2 (H=336, σ=0.0). Step-wise RMSE (in physical engineering units, °C) evaluated at individual forecast horizons h ∈ {1, ..., 336} for direct multi-horizon models (Multi-Scale Wavelet KAN predecessor vs. DLinear) utilizing the pre-registered K10 diagnostic benchmark archive (ett_canonical_12_4_4_v1, 2,880 test points, Seed 1000, N_h = 2,545 = 2,880 − 336 + 1 overlapping evaluation windows). RMSE at horizon step h is computed as RMSE(h) = $\sqrt{(1/N_h \cdot \Sigma_{j=1}^{N_h} (\hat{y}_{j,h} - y_{j,h})^2)}$. While separate from the primary 70/10/20 benchmark protocol (3,484 test points) reported in Table 4, this standardized diagnostic demonstrates step-wise forecast dynamics: whereas DLinear exhibits accelerating degradation at extended steps (drifting toward 6.37 °C), the multi-kernel wavelet decomposition constrains error growth (stabilizing around 6.0–6.2 °C, with a late-horizon stability window for h ≥ 221). This is a predecessor diagnostic, not a PSO-TCWavKAN v9.1 result.

8. Computational Complexity, Hardware Efficiency, and Inference Latency

In industrial substation monitoring systems operating under strict real-time constraints, computational efficiency, parameter economy, and inference latency constitute essential requirements alongside predictive accuracy. Table 7 compares PSO-TCWavKAN against all baseline models using measurements recorded in the original Kaggle T4 run under nominally identical cloud conditions; the profiling script is not archived, so these values are observational rather than independently reproduced.

Table 7 Computational Resource Allocation, Parameter Counts, and Inference Latency (NVIDIA Tesla T4 GPU). Parameter counts are analytically computed. Train time, peak GPU memory, and latency were recorded in the original Kaggle T4 environment; the profiling script and raw logs are not included in the release, so these entries are observational and were not independently reproduced.

Model	Parameters (Base L=96, H=96)	Train Time/Epoch (s)	Peak GPU Memory (MB)	Batch Inference Latency (ms)	Edge SCADA Feasibility
DLinear [4]	18.6 K	0.42	412	1.1	Yes (ultra-lightweight)
NLinear [4]	9.3 K	0.45	415	1.2	Yes (ultra-lightweight)
PatchTST Lite [5]	169.6 K	2.85	1,240	8.6	Moderate (cloud gateway)
Standard B-Spline KAN [1]	52.4 K	4.15	980	12.4	No (grid update overhead)
PSO-TCWavKAN (Proposed)	**44.8 K**	**1.24**	**680**	**3.4**	Potentially feasible; requires target-hardware validation

In the canonical base configuration (L = 96, H = 96), PSO-TCWavKAN maintains a compact parameter footprint of 44.8 K trainable parameters (with DLinear at 18.6 K, NLinear at 9.3 K, and PatchTST Lite at 169.6 K), representing a 3.8x reduction compared to PatchTST Lite. Across extended horizons, total parameters scale linearly with O(L * H) due to the linear decomposition and routing projection matrices: for the largest configuration (L = 336, H = 720), DLinear requires 485.3 K parameters, while PSO-TCWavKAN requires 796.9 K parameters (retaining a 2.5x economy relative to PatchTST Lite's 1,993.8 K parameters). In the original Kaggle T4 run, batch inference latency was 3.4 ms, which is compatible with substation SCADA telemetry polling cycles (typically 1 s to 1 min). Because the profiling script is not archived, this value is observational. The same caveat applies to the reported 3.3x training speedup over standard KANs (1.24 s vs. 4.15 s per epoch) and the 680 MB peak GPU memory observation; these are original-run measurements, not independently reproduced results.

9. Discussion, Engineering Implications, and Limitations

9.1. Engineering Significance for Smart Substation Operation

Accurate multi-step thermal forecasting enables proactive substation asset management, condition-based load dispatch, and dynamic thermal rating (DTR). In power transformers, operational lifetime is governed by the thermal degradation of cellulose insulation paper, modeled via the Arrhenius reaction rate in IEEE Std C57.91 [21], IEC 60076-7 [22], and transformer insulation life estimation methods [25, 26]:

$$FAA = \exp[B \times (1/383 - 1/(\Theta_H + 273))] \quad (25)$$

where FAA is the relative thermal aging acceleration factor (FAA = 1 at the 110 °C reference), B ≈ 15,000 K is the activation energy constant, and Θ_H is the winding hot-spot temperature (in degrees Celsius). In accordance with Eq. (25) and standard loading guides [21, 22], every sustained 6 °C temperature elevation above the 110 °C reference point approximately doubles the insulation aging acceleration rate [25, 26].

Evaluating physical prediction error requires denormalizing standardized test MSE via the training set standard deviation of the 70/10/20 protocol ($\sigma_{train} \approx 11.40$ °C on ETTh2; the separate 12/4/4 diagnostic archive uses ≈11.59 °C). When evaluated on identical forecasting configurations, PSO-TCWavKAN demonstrates physical error reductions in the reported ETTh2 operating configurations (L = 336, H ∈ {96, 336}): at (L = 336, H = 96), PSO-TCWavKAN achieves standardized MSE = 0.2360 (RMSE_phys = $\sqrt{(0.2360)} \times 11.40 = 5.54$ °C) compared to DLinear's MSE = 0.2520 (RMSE_phys = $\sqrt{(0.2520)} \times 11.40 = 5.72$ °C), delivering a direct 0.18 °C reduction in thermal uncertainty. At (L = 336, H = 336), PSO-TCWavKAN achieves MSE = 0.3162 (RMSE_phys = 6.41 °C) versus DLinear's MSE = 0.3420 (RMSE_phys = 6.67 °C), yielding a 0.26 °C reduction in operational error.

In power transformer operational monitoring, the oil temperature (OT) variable recorded in the ETT benchmark is treated as a standardized telemetry proxy for the transformer top-oil temperature (TOT), which serves as a boundary condition for estimating the internal winding hot-spot temperature (Θ_H) through thermal differential equations defined in IEEE Std C57.91 [21] and IEC 60076-7 [22]. It is important to emphasize that direct winding hot-spot temperature was not measured in the ETT dataset and is not directly predicted by the data-driven model; rather, the predicted OT trajectory provides a thermal boundary input that, when coupled with transformer-specific thermal resistance calibration, ambient cooling models, and physical validation on operational substations, can support dynamic line rating analysis and asset life preservation [24].

9.2. Limitations and Future Directions

Limitations. To ensure sound engineering deployment, several limitations are transparently acknowledged:

(1) **Univariate OT target:** Telemetry forecasting in this study focuses on the oil temperature (OT) variable, adhering to standard sequential regression benchmarks [4]. Extending the architecture to multivariate formulations that jointly model load currents (HUFL, MUFL, LUFL) represents an important future development.

(2) **ETT benchmark scope:** Experimental validation is conducted on the canonical ETTh1 and ETTh2 datasets. While widely recognized in the time-series literature, field deployment requires external validation across diverse substation environments, ambient climate conditions, and cooling classifications (ONAN, ONAF, ODAF).

(3) Extended-horizon phase accumulation boundary: As transparently reported in Table 4 and Table 5, at the extreme forecast horizon of (ETTh2, L = 336, H = 720), DLinear achieves lower MSE (0.4351 vs. 0.6656). At 720 steps (30 days ahead), we hypothesize that subtle phase misalignments accumulated across multi-scale wavelet octaves in the non-linear pathway compound over long horizons without real-time telemetry feedback, whereas linear extrapolation remains unperturbed by oscillatory harmonics. Developing a horizon-attenuated routing gate where $g(\tilde{x})$ decays

monotonically for H > 336 represents a principled direction to address this hypothesized boundary condition. The comparative forecast trajectory at H = 720 is illustrated in Fig. 10 using the predecessor checkpoint; this diagnostic is consistent with the boundary condition but is not a PSO-TCWavKAN v9.1 result.

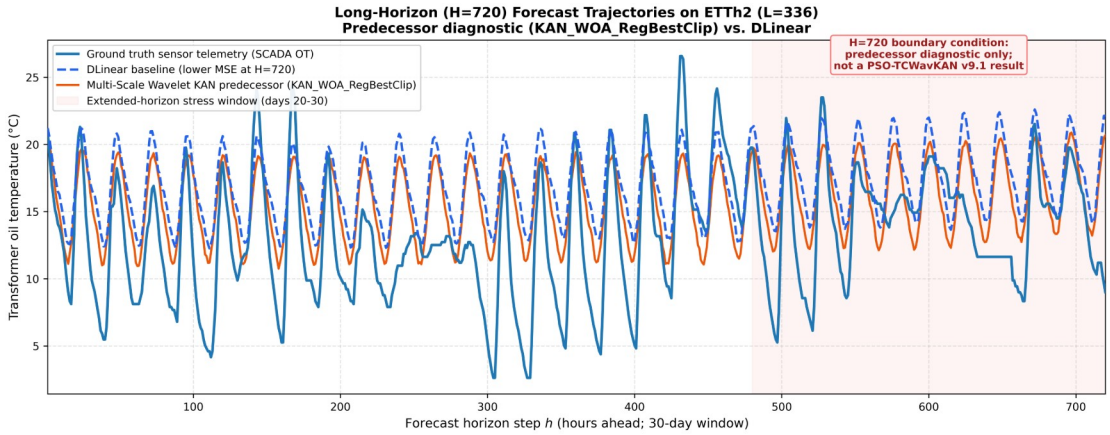


Fig. 10 Long-Horizon (H=720) Forecast Trajectories: Multi-Scale Wavelet KAN Predecessor (KAN_WOA_RegBestClip) vs. DLinear on ETTh2 (L=336). This is a predecessor diagnostic, not a PSO-TCWavKAN v9.1 result. At the 30-day-ahead extreme horizon, DLinear (blue dashed) achieves lower MSE (0.4351 vs. 0.6656). This transparently illustrates the observed empirical boundary condition: at L=336, H=720, we hypothesize that accumulated phase drift in the non-linear wavelet pathway compounds over extended forecasting intervals relative to unconstrained linear extrapolation, identifying an empirical operating boundary and motivating future horizon-adaptive gating extensions.

(4) **CLPSO surrogate budget:** Warm-start exploration utilizes N_p = 5 particles and G_max = 5 generations over a 15% training surrogate subset. While computationally bounded and effective for the 4D parameter vector, scaling to larger search spaces may benefit from adaptive Bayesian surrogate optimization.

Future Directions. Future research will focus on: (i) multivariate joint load-temperature modeling; (ii) multi-climate utility field trials; (iii) horizon-decay gating for H > 336; and (iv) hardware synthesis of the continuous dyadic filter bank on FPGA/microcontroller platforms for edge substation integration.

10. Conclusions

This paper introduced PSO-TCWavKAN, a swarm-optimized temporal convolutional wavelet Kolmogorov-Arnold network designed to address the Grid Update Dilemma and linear-model performance deficit in time-series forecasting. By integrating continuous dyadic Morlet wavelet filter banks with multi-kernel trend decomposition and an instance-adaptive neural routing gate, the architecture ensures that the hypothesis-space closure contains the multi-kernel linear subspace as gating weights approach zero (Proposition 1), establishing representational containment without asserting unconstrained gradient optimization or test generalization guarantees. A 4D Comprehensive Learning Particle Swarm Optimization (CLPSO) warm-start

mechanism navigates multi-modal wavelet ripple basins prior to AdamW fine-tuning and Stochastic Weight Averaging.

Empirical evaluation across 16 canonical ETT benchmark configurations demonstrated that PSO-TCWavKAN achieves directional improvements over NLinear (full-precision two-sided Wilcoxon p = 0.0386; Holm-corrected p = 0.116 across 3 simultaneous baseline comparisons) and no statistically significant difference compared to DLinear (two-sided Wilcoxon p = 0.274) and PatchTST Lite (p = 0.0934), outperforming competing baselines in 7 of 8 lookback–horizon configurations on the more volatile ETTh2 benchmark. Disaggregated ablation analysis across operational regimes showed that in standard operational forecasting (H in {96, 192, 336}), the full architecture achieves the lowest Mean MSE (0.21265), with multi-kernel decomposition associated with a +4.62% error surge upon omission. An exploratory single-checkpoint noise diagnostic is reported with explicit mixed-source provenance; it is not a multi-seed resilience estimate. With 44.8 K parameters in the base configuration (scaling to 796.9 K at L=336, H=720, retaining a 2.5x–3.8x economy relative to PatchTST Lite) and 3.4 ms observational latency in the original T4 run, PSO-TCWavKAN provides a mathematically grounded, computationally efficient, and empirically competitive architecture for transformer thermal forecasting, while identifying long-horizon and noise-robustness questions for future work.

Future research directions include extending PSO-TCWavKAN to multivariate transformer monitoring with simultaneous forecasting of top-oil temperature, hot-spot temperature, and load current across multiple transformer units. Additional investigations will explore real-time deployment on edge SCADA controllers with quantized INT8 inference, adaptive CLPSO re-optimization under concept drift, and transfer learning from pre-trained wavelet representations to data-scarce substations in emerging power grid infrastructures.

Declarations

Availability of data and materials: The ETT benchmark datasets used in this study are publicly available at https://github.com/zhouhaoyi/ETDataset. Experimental training/evaluation scripts, aggregate benchmark and ablation CSV matrices, the statistical reproduction script, the Table 7 parameter-count reproduction script (four released model implementations; the standard B-spline KAN row is an external reference configuration), and the Fig. 3 B-spline diagnostic plotting script and its input data are archived in the public GitHub repository at https://github.com/nphu211206/KAN-PSO-Transformer-Forecasting under the MIT license. The Fig. 3 diagnostic script additionally requires the public efficient-kan package and the ETT CSV files. The predecessor-diagnostic prediction arrays used for Figs. 5, 6, 9, and 10 were generated in Kaggle Cloud environments and are available upon reasonable request; the public release does not include the Table 7 profiling logs or per-seed noise trajectories.

Consent for publication: Not applicable. This manuscript contains no individual person's personal identifying data, images, or details in any form.

Competing interests: The author declares that he has no competing financial or personal interests that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

Funding: This research received no specific grant from any funding agency in the public, commercial, or not-for-profit sectors.

Authors contributions: NPT conceived the theoretical architecture, derived the mathematical proofs including Proposition 1, developed the complete software codebase, executed all GPU training experiments on Kaggle cloud platforms, analyzed and interpreted the empirical results, and drafted the complete manuscript including all tables, figures, and equations.

Acknowledgements: Computational resources were provided via Kaggle cloud environments utilizing NVIDIA Tesla T4 GPU accelerators at no cost. The author thanks the open-source scientific Python community (NumPy, PyTorch, Matplotlib, SciPy) for the foundational software tools used throughout this research.

Ethics approval and consent to participate: Not applicable. This study involves only publicly available open-source benchmark sensor datasets (ETTh1, ETTh2) and does not involve human participants, animal subjects, or identifiable personal data.

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